STRATEGIC REPORT FOR THE VALUE CHAIN · NOVEMBER 2026

# The Cloud and AI Development Act (CADA)

## Implications, bottlenecks and opportunities for vendors, distributors, resellers and integrators, and the end-customer industry in Spain and Portugal

Business, technical, regulatory and market analysis of proposal COM(2026) 502 —procedure 2026/0138(COD) — and its regulatory ecosystem (AI Act, Data Act, NIS2, CRA, DORA, DMA, WEEE, ecodesign), with the technology distribution channel at its centre.

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# 1. Executive summary

## Why this report

The Cloud and AI Development Act (CADA) was proposed by the European Commission on 3 June 2026 as the centrepiece of the Tech Sovereignty Package. It is the first Union law to turn digital sovereignty into verifiable requirements for the public procurement of cloud and AI services. It pursues two objectives: to triple Europe's data centre capacity within five to seven years, and to bring order to the public market through four sovereignty assurance levels and a mandatory risk assessment in the public sector [R1][R2].

This report analyses the proposal from the place where it is decided how technology reaches businesses and public administrations in Spain and Portugal: the distribution channel. It follows the entire value chain. At one end are the vendors of data infrastructure, servers, storage, networking, cybersecurity, and components for data centres and AI. In the middle are the value-added distributors that represent them on the Iberian Peninsula and the hundreds of resellers and integrators that buy from them to design, deploy and operate solutions. At the other end are the industrial and service companies that use that technology.

The question guiding this document is a practical one: what the CADA changes in the business of each link in the chain, what bottlenecks it may cause and what opportunities it opens up for those who prepare early.

## Key conclusions

- The CADA does not regulate the entire cloud market, but access to the public market. However, the assurance level will become a commercial seal that private customers in critical sectors (energy, health, finance, water, transport) will also demand [R1][R3].
- The assurance level is granted to each service, not to each company. That is why sovereignty is built along the chain: the integrator providing the service needs evidence that only the hardware and software vendor can supply and, increasingly, the distributor that supplies, configures and supports them.
- For vendors, the CADA introduces a new competitive dimension: where data and telemetry are processed, where support is delivered from, who controls the company and what its software supply chain contains. Those who document these answers in advance will be preferred by the channel.
- For integrators, level 1 is achievable through self-assessment. Levels 2 to 4 require audits, certification and architectures under European control, which few will be able to build on their own.
- For value-added distributors, the regulation strengthens their role as orchestrators: the multi-vendor catalogue, technical pre-sales, logistics within the Union, financing and training are exactly the resources an ecosystem that must prove sovereignty needs.
- The most likely bottlenecks are certification (the European EUCS scheme remains blocked), the shortage of European capacity and GPUs, memory price pressure in 2026, the talent gap and the risk of each Member State applying the regulation in its own way.

### Expected timeline

The proposal is going through the legislative process. The European Parliament presented its joint draft report on 11 November 2026, will debate it in committee on 1 December and expects to vote on it in committee around March 2027 and in plenary in April [R4][R5]. The political goal is an agreement in the fourth quarter of 2027. In the baseline scenario, the first practical obligations would arrive between 2028 and 2029, and the first tenders requiring specific levels between 2029 and 2030.

### What it means for the value chain

The Iberian channel comes to the CADA in good shape. The Spanish distribution market grew by 15.1 % in 2025 according to CONTEXT [R6], and one of the largest distributors on the peninsula, the Esprinet Group, increased its revenue by 21 % in Spain and 37 % in Portugal in the first half of 2026 [R7]. That strength is the basis for investing in what the CADA will require: documentary evidence, tiered architectures and service capabilities.

> **Key message: sovereignty is not demonstrated by a single player in isolation. It is demonstrated by a documented supply chain. The value-added distributor that organises that chain for its vendors and integrators will enjoy an advantage that is hard to replicate between 2027 and 2030.**

| Player | Main effect of the CADA | Urgency |
|---|---|---|
| **Vendors** | Document control, location, support and software supply chain | High |
| **Value-added distributors** | Orchestrate a tiered catalogue, evidence and services | High |
| **Integrators** | Tiered catalogue and sovereignty file per service | High |
| **Public customers** | Risk assessment and procurement by level | Medium (2028–2029) |
| **Critical private customers** | Voluntary assessment; possible sector-specific obligation | Medium |

## 2. The Iberian technology channel and the role of the value-added distributor

### How technology reaches the end customer

In Europe, and especially in Spain and Portugal, most professional technology is not sold directly by the vendor. It travels along a two-tier chain: the vendor sells to the distributor, the distributor sells to the reseller or integrator, and the latter sells, deploys and operates the solution for the end customer. This model exists because no vendor can efficiently manage thousands of relationships with small and medium-sized resellers; the distributor aggregates demand, finances inventory, takes on credit risk and provides logistics and technical training [R8][R9].

Margins at each link are thin. In hardware, the distributor's margin is usually between 3 % and 8 %, offset by volume, vendor incentives and value-added services; the combined margins of distributor and reseller can account for between 35 % and 50 % of the final price depending on the category [R8]. That is why every regulatory change that adds work to the chain must be turned into a billable service or a commercial advantage if it is not to erode profitability.

INFOGRAPHIC 01 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

## The CADA reaches a growing Iberian channel: sovereignty will become the next value specialisation

Key figures of proposal COM(2026) 502 and of the technology channel in Spain and Portugal

### THE REGULATION

**4**
**Sovereignty assurance levels**
Level 1 by self-assessment; levels 2–4 with independent audit

**×3**
**Data centre capacity**
EU target within five to seven years

**25 %**
**Innovative buying from SMEs**
Target for public cloud and AI (Art. 33)

### THE CHANNEL

**+15,1 %**
**Distributors in Spain 2025**
Growth in distribution business according to CONTEXT

**+21 %**
**Esprinet Spain H1 2026**
€866.2m revenue; Portugal +37 %

**650+**
**Vendors in the Esprinet Group**
And more than 31,000 resellers in southern Europe

### CHANNEL SHARE OF IT SPENDING (OMDIA, 2026)




**TAKEAWAY** The level is granted to each service, but the evidence is spread across vendor, distributor and integrator: sovereignty is demonstrated by the chain.

Source: [R1] COM(2026) 502; [R6] CONTEXT via Newsbook; [R7] Esprinet H1 2026; [R16] Esprinet; [R10][R11][R12] Omdia.

## The weight of the channel in technology spending

According to Omdia, partners channelled 70.1 % of global IT spending in 2025 and will channel 66.7 % in 2026: they are losing share to direct sales by the large providers, but their absolute volume keeps growing and their influence on decisions is increasing [R10]. Among SMEs in Europe, the Middle East and Africa, 82 % of IT spending goes through partners [R11], and in cybersecurity the proportion reaches 91.7 % [R12]. In Spain, the channel structure is highly fragmented: according to Dell, 98 % of its partners are SMEs [R13]. Moreover, the customer no longer decides alone: according to Canalys, the B2B buyer goes through an average of 28 touchpoints before choosing a supplier, accompanied by several trusted partners, which gives the channel influence beyond the transaction itself [R14].

## Broadline distributors and value-added distributors

Two types of distributor coexist on the peninsula. Broadline distributors (TD SYNNEX, Ingram Micro, Esprinet, MCR, Infortisa, DMI, Globomatik, among others) move workplace, peripheral and consumer volume with logistical efficiency [R15]. Value-added distributors, such as Arrow, V-Valley, Exclusive Networks or Westcon-Comstor, specialise in data centre, networking, cybersecurity, cloud and AI, with technical pre-sales, labs, training, professional services and financing.

## The value-added distributor in figures

The large distribution groups work with hundreds of vendors and tens of thousands of resellers: the Esprinet Group, for example, reports more than 650 vendors and more than 31,000 resellers in southern Europe [R16], and in 2025 it posted gross revenue of EUR 1,765.4 million in Spain (+10 %) and EUR 106 million in Portugal (+47 %) [R17]. In the first half of 2026 its revenue grew by 21 % in Spain and 37 % in Portugal [R7]. In 2024, its value division contributed around 25 % of turnover and more than 60 % of the group's EBITDA [R18]: added value is the engine of the distributor's profitability.

Value-added distributors are broadening their catalogues with recent agreements in cybersecurity, observability, physical infrastructure, mobility, digital energy and AI-ready colocation [R19][R20], and are setting up dedicated units for AI training and support for their partners [R21].

## Why the channel is where the CADA will be played out

The CADA measures the sovereignty of each service on the basis of data that is spread across the chain: the vendor knows where its equipment sends telemetry and who maintains its code; the distributor knows where first-line support is delivered from and how licences are managed; the integrator knows where the service runs and who operates it. No single link has all the information. Whoever gathers it, standardises it and makes it available to the others will become indispensable.

> **The channel is not a passive intermediary under the CADA: it is the only point in the chain that sees the vendor, the integrator and the customer at the same time.**

| Link | Role in the channel | Examples in Iberia |
|---|---|---|
| **Vendor** | Product, partner programme, incentives | Dell, HP, Lenovo, HPE, Cisco, Huawei, Vertiv, Fortinet |

| Link | Role in the channel | Examples in Iberia |
|---|---|---|
| **Value-added distributor** | Pre-sales, multi-vendor integration, financing | V-Valley, Arrow, Exclusive Networks, Westcon-Comstor |
| **Broadline distributor** | Logistics, stock, credit, volume | TD SYNNEX, Ingram Micro, MCR, Infortisa, DMI |
| **Integrator / MSP** | Project, deployment, operation | SEIDOR, Nunsys, Telefónica Tech, INTEGRA, ACICATECH |
| **End customer** | Use of the technology | Industry, services, public sector, SMEs |

# 3. What the CADA is: origin, architecture and timeline

## From Draghi to the Tech Sovereignty Package

The idea of a European cloud and AI development act first appeared in the Draghi report on competitiveness (September 2024). The Commission incorporated it into the AI Continent Action Plan (April 2025), opened a call for evidence in 2025 and adopted proposal COM(2026) 502 on 3 June 2026, together with the Chips Act 2.0, the European Open Source Strategy and a roadmap for the digitalisation of the energy sector [R1][R2][R22]. Its legal basis is Articles 114 and 173(3) TFEU, and it takes the form of a regulation, directly applicable in all Member States.

## The diagnosis

The Commission identifies two problems. The first is insufficient and concentrated computing capacity: AI demand is growing faster than Europe's data centre supply. The second is dependency: the share of European cloud providers fell from 29 % in 2017 to 15 % in 2022, while three non-European hyperscalers hold more than 70 % of the market [R1].

## Architecture of the proposal

The proposal is organised into five titles, 48 articles and three annexes [R1]:

- Title I: subject matter and definitions.
- Title II (Arts. 3–9): cloud and AI leadership initiatives, AI Centres built on the digital innovation hubs, national strategies and frontier AI projects.
- Title III (Arts. 10–15): data centre acceleration zones, single points of information, permits and strategic projects.
- Title IV (Arts. 16–44): sovereignty framework with four levels, recognition, auditing, authorities, public-sector risk assessment, procurement, EuroCloud Federation, joint procurement and open source.
- Title V (Arts. 45–48): delegated acts, review and entry into force.
- Annexes: major technological challenges (I), requirements for each level (II) and audit evidence (III).

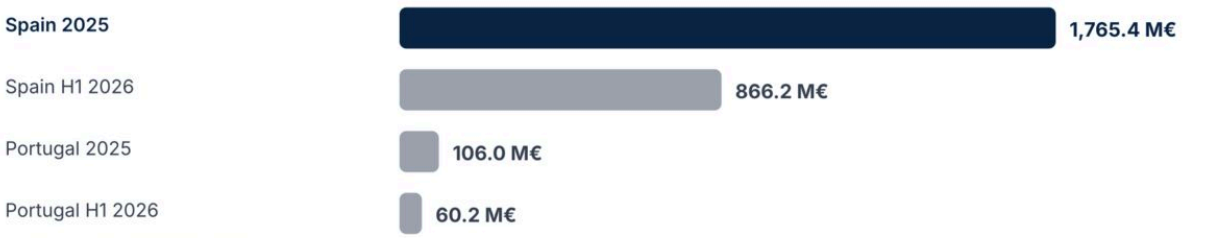
INFOGRAPHIC 02 · THE IBERIAN CHANNEL

## Professional technology reaches the customer through a two-tier chain, and the value-added distributor holds the link that sees everyone

Role of each link and weight of a large distribution group on the peninsula




ESPRINET GROUP GROSS REVENUE (€M)




ECONOMICS OF THE MODEL

| Indicator | Value | Source |
|---|---|---|
| Distributor margin on hardware | 3–8 % | Unifyr |
| Combined channel margins | 35–50 % of final price | Unifyr |
| Value division of a large group (2024) | ≈ 25 % of turnover; > 60 % of EBITDA | Newsbook |
| SME partners in Spain | 98 % (Dell) | Newsbook |

**TAKEAWAY** With thin margins, every new obligation must become a billable service or a commercial advantage for the channel.

Source: [R17] Esprinet FY2025; [R7] H1 2026; [R8] Unifyr; [R18] Newsbook; [R13] Newsbook/Gadesoft.

## What the CADA is not

The CADA does not prohibit any provider from operating in the private market, does not impose data localisation on all companies and does not replace the AI Act. Its direct obligations fall on the public sector and on providers that seek recognition of a level. Its indirect effect, however, will be broad, because Article 31 allows voluntary assessments by critical private entities and empowers the Commission to make them mandatory in highly critical sectors [R1].

## Timeline

As of 14 November 2026, the CADA is at first reading. In the Council it is being examined in the telecommunications working party; the Irish Presidency is preparing a progress report for the end of the year and the Legal Service considers the proposal compatible with the WTO, with adjustments to the European preferences [R23]. In Parliament, the rapporteurs presented the joint draft report on 11 November 2026; the committee debate is scheduled for 1 December, the committee vote for mid-March 2027 and the plenary vote for April [R5]. The draft calls for more investment in European cloud and AI infrastructure, greater protection of critical sectors, more public procurement from European providers and faster permitting for data centres. One of the rapporteurs, Diego Solier, has indicated that the requirements could be softened and that the rules for international companies will be clarified [R4]. The text enters into force twenty days after its publication and applies one year later, with staggered deadlines for Member States (the European Economic and Social Committee and the European Data Protection Supervisor have already issued their opinions [R24][R25]): six months for acceleration zones, twelve for authorities, strategies and risk assessments, and a maximum of twelve months to migrate services where the assessment requires it.

## What it means for the channel

The timeline offers a two-year preparation window. For a vendor, it is time to document its supply chain and adapt support contracts. For a value-added distributor, it is time to classify its catalogue and design evidence services. For an integrator, it is time to inventory its services and decide which ones it will take to higher levels.

> **Timeline recommendation: 2027 as the year of diagnosis and offer design, 2028 as the year of evidence and alliances, and 2029 as the year of the first tenders with CADA requirements.**

| Milestone | Date | Type |
|---|---|---|
| **Proposal COM(2026) 502** | 3 Jun 2026 | Done |
| **Parliament draft report** | 11 Nov 2026 | Done |
| **Committee vote** | Mar 2027 | Planned |
| **Political agreement** | Q4 2027 | Indicative target |
| **General application** | 2029 (baseline scenario) | Estimate |

INFOGRAPHIC 03 · WHAT THE CADA IS

## Five titles, 48 articles and a two-year window before effective application in 2029

Legislative milestones and deadlines triggered by entry into force




Done · Planned · Scenario / estimate

DEADLINES FROM ENTRY INTO FORCE

| Obligation | Deadline | Article |
|---|---|---|
| Data centre acceleration zones | 6 months | 10 |
| National cloud and AI strategy | 12 months | 7 |
| National competent authorities | 12 months | 25 |
| Public-sector risk assessment | 12 months; then every 2 years | 29 |
| Migration to the required level | Maximum 12 months | 29 |
| Review of Annexes II and III | Every 18 months | 16 |

**WINDOW** 2027: diagnosis and offer. 2028: evidence and alliances. 2029: first tenders with CADA requirements.

Source: [R1] COM(2026) 502; [R2] OEIL; [R4] MLex. Dates from 2027: baseline scenario, illustrative.

# 4. Titles II and III: leadership, frontier AI and data centres

## The leadership initiatives

Articles 3 to 6 create a Cloud Leadership Initiative and an AI Leadership Initiative with R&D objectives: next-generation cloud and AI technologies, open and efficient stacks covering everything from the edge to data, and industrial, physical and frontier AI [R1][R3]. They have no budget of their own: they will be implemented through Horizon Europe, the Digital Europe Programme and the future European Competitiveness Fund. Article 5 creates a network of AI Centres built on the European Digital Innovation Hubs (EDIHs), which will bring AI experimentation closer to SMEs and public administrations, in line with the Commission's Apply AI strategy [R26].

## National strategies

Article 7 requires each Member State to adopt a national cloud and AI strategy within twelve months, aligned with the Digital Decade (75 % of companies using cloud, big data and AI, and 10,000 secure edge nodes) and including measures to support stacks based on open hardware and software [R1]. These strategies will translate into public procurement plans and SME adoption plans, which represent direct demand for the channel.

## Frontier AI and gigafactories

Articles 8 and 9 make it possible to recognise priority frontier AI projects and allocate computing to them in coordination with the AI Factories and the future EuroHPC AI gigafactories. The gigafactory call, which closed on 12 November 2026, provides for up to seven facilities with more than 100,000 AI processors each [R27]. Spain has submitted a joint Madrid–Catalonia bid.

## Acceleration zones and strategic projects

Title III addresses physical scarcity. Article 10 requires the designation of at least one data centre acceleration zone within six months; Article 13 caps at twelve months the permitting decision for projects of the highest relevance; Article 14 allows the designation of strategic projects that meet at least two of five criteria: essential public functions, sustainability or innovation, grid stability, use of chips, servers or quantum computers manufactured in the Union, or relief of an identified computing shortage [R1]. Data centres with European chips or a smaller energy footprint could obtain priority grid connection and better network tariffs [R22].

## What it means for vendors, distributors and integrators

For vendors of servers, storage, power and cooling, Title III is a demand-side policy: more data centres mean more orders for critical infrastructure. The criterion of hardware manufactured in the Union may reward those with European production or assembly, and the Annex I target (average PUE of 1.15 and server utilisation of around 50 %) favours more efficient equipment. For value-added distributors, which distribute data centre infrastructure and sign agreements with power and cooling vendors and colocation operators [R19][R20], the wave of investment is the most tangible short-term opportunity. For integrators, the AI Centres and national strategies open up adoption projects among SMEs and public administrations, and the AI Factories offer computing to fine-tune sector-specific models.

> **Title III turns sovereignty into megawatts: the chain that supplies efficient servers, power, cooling and racks to the new European data centres will capture the first wave of value from the CADA.**

| Measure | Article | Deadline | Opportunity for the channel |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Leadership initiatives** | 3–6 | EU programmes | Open stacks, edge, funded projects |
| **AI Centres** | 5 | Network built on EDIHs | SME channel and pilots |
| **National strategy** | 7 | 12 months | Procurement and adoption plans |
| **Acceleration zones** | 10 | 6 months | Demand for data centre infrastructure |
| **Strategic projects** | 14 | Calls | European and efficient hardware |

# 5. The sovereignty framework: four assurance levels

## The core of the proposal

Article 16 creates the Union's cloud sovereignty framework with four assurance levels set out in Annex II. It transposes into binding law criteria on ownership, control and exposure to foreign jurisdictions that had been removed from the EUCS certification scheme for lack of agreement among Member States [R28]. Law firms that have analysed the proposal stress that, in practice, it also creates new compliance tiers for software providers [R29]. The levels are voluntary for providers, but they determine which services the administration may procure for each activity.

## What each level requires

Level 1. Provider established in the Union; infrastructure and assets, including those of subcontractors, in the Union unless the public customer requests otherwise; customer data, metadata and telemetry in the Union; support outsourced outside the EU that does not compromise operational autonomy; state-of-the-art cybersecurity; declared subcontractors; and, where there is third-country control, assurance that no foreign law requires vulnerabilities to be disclosed before they are known to be exploited [R1].

Level 2. In addition: provider, subcontractors, infrastructure and staff in the Union; European cybersecurity certificate at "substantial" level (or national schemes until one exists); prohibition on using service data to train AI of third-country entities; support initiated and delivered exclusively from the Union; software supply chain controls (SBOM, control of remote functions, code audits of third-country components, migration plans); and legal, technical and organisational separation from the non-EU parent company [R1].

Level 3. Staff with Union citizenship and, where applicable, security clearance; "substantial" certificate; provider not controlled by a third country, save for a derogation linked to a recognised third country with safeguards such as reasonable access to the code [R1].

Level 4. No third-country control; sensitive data always in the Union; "high" certificate; and effective control of the software supply chain, so that no third country controls the design, development, maintenance or evolution of the components [R1].

INFOGRAPHIC 04 · TITLES II AND III

## The CADA turns sovereignty into megawatts: the first wave of demand will be for infrastructure

Leadership and capacity measures and what they mean for vendors, distributors and integrators

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Leadership initiatives (Arts. 3–6)**<br>Open cloud stacks, edge, industrial and frontier AI; funded by Horizon Europe and Digital Europe. | Funded projects |
| 2 | **AI Centres (Art. 5)**<br>Network built on the European Digital Innovation Hubs to bring AI to SMEs and administrations. | SME channel |
| 3 | **National strategy (Art. 7)**<br>Within 12 months: adoption and procurement plans; support for open hardware and software stacks. | Public demand |
| 4 | **Acceleration zones (Art. 10)**<br>At least one per Member State in 6 months; permits in max. 12 months for priority projects. | DC infrastructure |
| 5 | **Strategic projects (Art. 14)**<br>2 of 5 criteria: public functions, sustainability, grid, EU-made hardware, computing shortage. | European hardware |
| 6 | **Annex I: major challenges**<br>Average PUE of 1.15 and server utilisation of around 50 % as efficiency targets. | Efficient equipment |

WHAT A NEW DATA CENTRE BUYS

**Power**
UPS and distribution
Supply, backup and management

**Cooling**
Cooling
Air, liquid, cooled doors

**IT**
Servers and network
Compute, GPU, storage

**TAKEAWAY** The chain that supplies efficient power, cooling, racks and servers to the new European data centres will capture the first wave of value.

Source: [R1] COM(2026) 502; [R22] Freshfields/Jones Day; [R19] distributor press releases.

## How it is demonstrated

Level 1 is demonstrated by self-assessment, and SME declarations are valid throughout the Union without prior recognition (Arts. 17(3) and 19). Levels 2 to 4 require an independent audit with the evidence set out in Annex III (Art. 20); recognised services are entered in a central Commission repository and material changes must be notified (Arts. 22 and 23) [R1].

## Why moving between levels is a matter for the whole chain

The critical jump is between levels 1 and 2. Level 2 requires support to be delivered from the Union, the software supply chain to be documented and data not to train third-party models. None of these three conditions depends solely on the integrator: second- and third-line support is provided by the vendor; the SBOM is generated by the vendor; data use conditions are set in the vendor's contracts. And the distributor is usually the one managing first-line support, licences and spare-parts logistics. Levels 3 and 4 also depend on who controls the vendor, something neither the distributor nor the integrator can change.

## Example of a tiered catalogue

An integrator offering backup, virtualisation, cloud ERP and monitoring will assess each service separately. Backup on storage from a vendor with support in the Union, hosted in a European data centre, may aspire to level 2 or 3. ERP on a non-European hyperscaler may demonstrate level 1 if it meets the localisation, telemetry and transparency requirements. The right strategy is not to choose one level for the whole company, but to build a tiered catalogue with products the distributor has already classified.

## Case study: level 2 backup for a hospital

A regional integrator wants to offer a public hospital a managed backup service. If the risk assessment classifies electronic health records as a public-order activity, the service will have to reach at least level 2. The integrator will need: a data centre established in the Union with staff in the Union; a storage system and data protection software whose advanced support is delivered from the Union; a management console that does not send telemetry outside Europe; the SBOM of the components; and an accepted cybersecurity certification (in Spain, the National Security Framework (ENS) at high category until the European certificate exists). The integrator manufactures none of these pieces. If its distributor provides a reference configuration with vendors that already supply that evidence and a regional operator with an accredited level, the integrator can prepare its file in weeks rather than months.

> **The level is granted to the service, but it is earned along the chain. A vendor that does not provide its share of the evidence leaves its integrators out of levels 2 to 4.**

| Level | Demonstration | Certificate | Third-country control | Support |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | Self-assessment | State of the art | Allowed with safeguards | Outside the EU without compromising autonomy |
| **2** | Audit | EU "substantial" | Allowed with separation | Exclusively from the EU |
| **3** | Audit | EU "substantial" | No (unless recognised country) | EU, staff with EU citizenship |

| Level | Demonstration | Certificate | Third-country control | Support |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | Audit | EU "high" | No | EU, citizenship and clearance |

# 6. Evidence under Annexes II and III across the supply chain

## From principles to proof

Annex III defines how each requirement is demonstrated and turns sovereignty into a file that an auditor verifies [R1]. Its criteria are:

- A. Establishment in the Union: deeds, registered office, central administration and stable presence.
- B. Infrastructure, assets and staff: addresses of all infrastructure, including backups, disaster recovery and logs, and asset inventories.
- C. Data localisation: access logs, flow diagrams and contracts showing that there are no transfers outside the Union without approval.
- D. Staff citizenship: identities, organisation charts and access control.
- E. Cybersecurity certification: certificates under Regulation (EU) 2019/881 or, until a scheme exists, aligned with CEN/TS 18026:2024 or national schemes.
- F. Third-country AI: clauses prohibiting training on the data, MLOps logs in the EU, model cards and data lineage.
- G. Ownership and control: shareholders with at least 5 %, governance rules and a register of third-country access requests.
- H. Support from the Union: clauses, register of subcontractors, administrative access paths and access revocation.
- I. Software supply chain transparency.

## Who holds each piece of evidence

Read from the channel's perspective, Annex III is a division of labour. Criterion A and much of C are handled by the integrator or the service operator. B requires knowing where the equipment and spare parts are and who maintains them, information shared between distributor and integrator. E depends on the certification of the products and the service. Criteria F, G, H and I depend above all on the vendor: only the vendor can declare its ownership structure, where advanced support is delivered from, what remote functions its firmware or software includes and what third-country components it integrates.

## The role of the distributor

For a mid-sized integrator, requesting this information from dozens of vendors is not feasible. A value-added distributor can standardise it: ask each vendor for a sovereignty sheet per product family, keep it up to date, translate it into the language of Annex III and make it available to partners on its portal. It is a service similar to the one it already provides with datasheets, certifications, warranties and recycling or product safety compliance.

INFOGRAPHIC 05 · SOVEREIGNTY FRAMEWORK

## Four assurance levels: the critical jump for the channel is between level 1 and level 2

Cumulative requirements of Annex II and how they are demonstrated

### Level 1

Self-assessment; valid EU-wide for SMEs

- Provider established in the EU
- Declared subcontractors
- External support without loss of autonomy
- Data, metadata and telemetry in the EU
- State-of-the-art cybersecurity
- Assurance on vulnerabilities

### Level 2

Independent audit

- Infrastructure and staff in the EU
- Support only from the EU
- SBOM and control of remote functions
- EU "substantial" certificate
- Data does not train third-party AI
- Separation from non-EU parent

### Level 3

Independent audit

- Staff with EU citizenship
- No third-country control
- Reasonable access to code
- Clearance where applicable
- Exception: recognised country
- "Substantial" certificate

### Level 4

Independent audit

- No third-country control
- EU "high" certificate
- Design and evolution in-house
- Sensitive data always in the EU
- Effective control of software
- Most sensitive cases

WHO PROVIDES WHAT LEVEL 2 REQUIRES

| Level 2 requirement | Vendor | Distributor | Integrator |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Support exclusively from the EU** | 2nd- and 3rd-line support | 1st-line support and spares | Service operation |
| **Software chain (SBOM)** | Generates the SBOM | Standardises, shares | Adds it to the file |
| **Data never trains others' AI** | Contractual clause | Passes on conditions | Contract with the customer |

**TAKEAWAY** The level is granted to the service, but earned along the chain: without the vendor's share, the integrator cannot go beyond level 1.

Source: [R1] COM(2026) 502, Arts. 16–20 and Annex II; division of tasks: our own analysis.

### Costs and difficulties

Criteria A, C and H are manageable for European providers. Criteria D, F, G and I are costly when the stack includes components from non-European vendors, because the evidence depends on information only they hold. The European Data Protection Supervisor has also asked that proof of staff citizenship respect data minimisation [R25].

### Tools

Practice will combine governance, risk and compliance platforms, automated asset inventories, SBOMs generated in continuous integration, data lineage logs for AI and standard clauses with suppliers. The verifiable credentials and self-descriptions of federated data spaces (Gaia-X, IDSA) can serve as a reusable format for exchanging evidence between companies [R30].

> **A sovereignty sheet per product, maintained by the distributor with vendor data, can save each integrator weeks of work per service and become a de facto standard for the Iberian channel.**

| Criterion | Who provides the evidence | Difficulty with a non-European stack |
|---|---|---|
| **A Establishment** | Integrator / operator | Low |
| **B Infrastructure and assets** | Integrator and distributor | Medium |
| **C Data localisation** | Integrator and vendor (telemetry) | Medium |
| **D Staff citizenship** | Integrator, vendor and distributor (support) | Medium |
| **E Certification** | Vendor and integrator | Medium |
| **F Third-country AI** | Vendor | High |
| **G Ownership and control** | Vendor | High |
| **H Support from the EU** | Vendor and distributor | High |
| **I Software supply chain** | Vendor | High |

## 7. Recognition, national authorities and procedure

### Who grants recognition and how

A provider seeking recognition of a service at a given level applies to the competent authority of the Member State where it is established (Art. 17). Each Member State designates that authority within one year (Art. 25) and gives it supervisory powers (Art. 26); the authorities cooperate through mutual assistance and cross-border cooperation (Arts. 27 and 28) [R1].

### Procedural deadlines

- The authority assesses the evidence within 60 days of admitting the application.
- The other Member States have 60 days to review it.
- Requests for information suspend the deadline, for a maximum of 30 days unless justified.

INFOGRAPHIC 06 · ANNEX III

## Sovereignty evidence is spread across the chain: the vendor holds the hardest proof

Weight of each player in Annex III criteria A–I (high = provides the main evidence)

| | Vendor | Distributor | Integrator |
|---|---|---|---|
| A · Establishment in the EU | Low | Low | High |
| B · Infrastructure and assets | Medium | Medium | High |
| C · Data and telemetry localisation | High | Low | High |
| D · Staff citizenship | Medium | Low | Medium |
| E · Cybersecurity certification | High | Low | Medium |
| F · Third-country AI | High | Low | Low |
| G · Ownership and control | High | Low | Low |
| H · Support from the EU | High | Medium | Low |
| I · Software supply chain | High | Medium | Low |

PROPOSAL: SOVEREIGNTY SHEET PER PRODUCT FAMILY




**TAKEAWAY** A sheet maintained by the distributor can save each integrator weeks of work per service and become a standard for the Iberian channel.

Source: [R1] Annex III; allocation by player and sovereignty sheet: our own analysis.

- Before a rejection, the provider has 30 days to submit observations.
- Consultations between authorities are answered within 15 days.

In practice, a level 2 to 4 recognition without incidents could be decided in around four months from admission, plus six to twelve months of evidence preparation and auditing in a mid-sized organisation (our own estimate).

## Recognised third countries

Article 18 allows the recognition of third countries whose providers could qualify for level 3 if cumulative conditions are met: adequacy under the GDPR, no controls incompatible with the Data Act, no possibility of being compelled to interrupt the service, no blocking of access to cutting-edge technology, a market open to Union providers and reciprocity in public procurement [R1]. For US, Japanese, Korean or Taiwanese vendors selling through the Iberian channel, this clause will largely determine their role at the higher levels.

## Penalties

Article 24 requires Member States to lay down effective, proportionate and dissuasive penalties, with no amounts specified in the proposal, which points to differences between countries [R1].

## Spain and Portugal

Spain will have to decide which body acts as the authority: the National Cryptologic Centre (Centro Criptológico Nacional, CCN), given its role in the National Security Framework (ENS) and product certification, or a unit of the Ministry for Digital Transformation. Portugal will have to do the same with its National Cybersecurity Centre. The choice matters: a body with certification experience will speed up recognitions; a new one may create bottlenecks.

## What it means for the channel

For integrators, recognition will be a project with an owner, a budget and a timeline. For vendors, the key is to deliver to their partners their share of the evidence in a reusable format and to communicate material changes (new support regions, changes of ownership, new components) so that the integrator can comply with Article 23. For the value-added distributor, there is room to offer recognition support: preparing the file, coordinating with auditors and maintaining the evidence, alone or with specialist partners.

> **Operational risk: if 27 authorities start at the same time with few accredited auditors, the first 12 to 18 months may generate queues. Complete, early files will avoid the bottleneck.**

| Phase | Responsible party | Deadline |
|---|---|---|
| **Evidence preparation** | Provider, with vendor and distributor data | 6–12 months (estimate) |
| **Audit (levels 2–4)** | Auditing body | Variable |
| **Assessment by the authority** | National authority | 60 days |
| **Review by other Member States** | National authorities | 60 days |
| **Entry in the repository** | Commission | After recognition |

INFOGRAPHIC 07 · RECOGNITION

## A level 2–4 recognition can be decided in about four months, but the evidence takes six to twelve

Article 17 procedure and the role of each player




CANDIDATES FOR COMPETENT AUTHORITY

| Country | Natural candidates | Basis |
|---|---|---|
| Spain | National Cryptologic Centre or a unit of the Ministry for Digital Transformation | ENS and certification |
| Portugal | National Cybersecurity Centre | National cybersecurity |

**RISK** If 27 authorities start at once with few auditors, the first 12–18 months may create queues: complete, early files will avoid the bottleneck.

Source: [R1] Arts. 17–28; preparation times and candidates: our own analysis.

# 8. Public-sector risk assessment and new procurement rules

## The mechanism that creates demand

If the levels are the supply side, Articles 29 to 33 create the demand. Article 29 requires Member States and Union entities to carry out, within one year and every two years thereafter, a risk assessment identifying which public activities contribute to public order and which level (2, 3 or 4) each requires, according to the sensitivity of the data, the risk of unlawful access by third countries and the risk of disruption. If the assessment requires migration, the transition may not exceed twelve months [R1].

## The procurement rule

Article 30 translates the assessment into rules:

- Bodies without public-order activities will procure services of at least level 1.
- Bodies with public-order activities will only procure level 2, 3 or 4 services, according to their assessment.
- Derogations apply where no suitable service exists, a similar tender has received no bids or compliance would be disproportionately costly [R1].

According to activeMind's analysis, public-order activities in NIS2 sectors, as well as internal security, defence, justice and law enforcement, could only use levels 2 to 4 [R3].

## Private sector

Article 31 allows private entities in the sectors listed in Annex I of NIS2 (energy, transport, banking, financial market infrastructure, health, water, digital infrastructure, ICT service management, space) to carry out voluntary assessments, and empowers the Commission to make them mandatory in highly critical sectors [R1]. For integrators serving hospitals, utilities, the food industry or logistics, this route is as relevant as the public one.

## European added value and SMEs

Article 32 requires innovative cloud and AI procurement to include non-price criteria that reward the use of technology developed in the EU, hardware manufactured in the EU and security of supply, without being decisive (recital 67 suggests up to 15 out of 120 points). Article 33 sets the target that at least 25 % of innovative cloud and AI procurement should go to innovative SMEs [R1].

## What it means for each player

For vendors, the criterion on European hardware and technology introduces points in tender specifications that do not exist today; those with manufacturing, assembly or development in the Union should document it. For integrators, each customer's risk assessment is the document to read before the tender specifications: routine administrative management will probably remain at level 1, while health, justice, security, taxation and some registries may move to levels 2 or 3. For the value-added distributor, the risk assessment makes it possible to anticipate which product families will see demand at each level

and to prepare reference configurations with vendors for each case. The 25 % SME target favours the channel's base of SME integrators over the large global integrators, provided they demonstrate innovation.

### Case study: a provincial council

A provincial council (diputación) with tax management, human resources, e-government portal and municipal support services will carry out its first risk assessment around 2029 in the baseline scenario. It is reasonable to expect (our own analysis) that tax management and some registries will be classified as public-order activities, requiring level 2, while human resources, routine document management and the institutional website remain at level 1. For the channel, that council becomes two distinct markets: a level 1 market open to almost all providers, and a level 2 market where only those that have prepared the configuration and the evidence will compete. The integrator that knows the assessment before the tender will be able to propose a mixed architecture, and the distributor that has validated both configurations will be able to back several bids from different integrators.

> **The Article 29 risk assessment will be the map of the public cloud market. The channel that reads it before the competition will reach the tender specifications with the configuration already validated.**

| Situation | Minimum level | Derogation |
|---|---|---|
| **Activity with no relevance to public order** | Level 1 | Not applicable |
| **Public-order activity** | Level 2, 3 or 4 | No service, tender with no bids or disproportionate cost |
| **Migration required** | According to the assessment | Maximum 12-month transition |
| **Private NIS2 Annex I entity** | Voluntary | Mandatory only by delegated act |

## 9. Joint procurement, EuroCloud Federation and open source

### The Commission as a central purchasing body

Articles 37 to 40 allow the Commission to procure cloud services, software and AI for Union entities and Member State contracting authorities, acting as a central purchasing body following an agreement with at least two Member States. Fees are set in advance; the financial statement estimates an average fee of around 2 % of each participating authority's spending, with around EUR 6 million in annual revenue from 2029 [R1]. For small Member States, the attraction is collective purchasing power [R31].

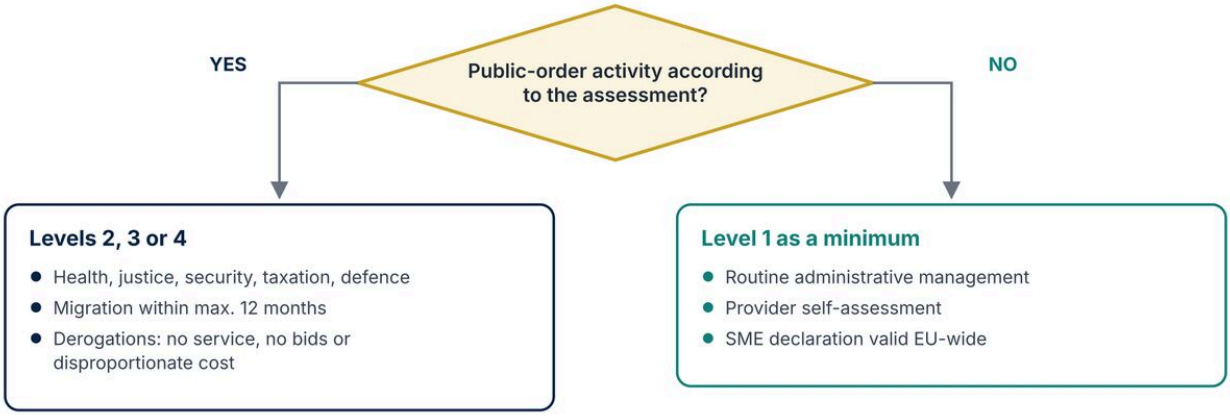
### EuroCloud Federation

Articles 34 to 36 create a voluntary federation enabling European institutions and public bodies to share data centre capacity and cloud services. The fee would be around EUR 75,000 per member from the second year, falling to around EUR 30,000 with full participation [R1]. Part of the public infrastructure could stop being procured from the market and be obtained from other bodies instead.

INFOGRAPHIC 08 · PUBLIC DEMAND

## The Article 29 risk assessment will be the map of the public cloud market

How the required level is decided for each procurement (Arts. 29–33)




RULES THAT ADD POINTS FOR THE CHANNEL

| Rule | Content | Beneficiary |
|---|---|---|
| **EU added value (Art. 32)** | EU technology and hardware; up to 15 of 120 points (indicative) | **Vendors with EU production or development** |
| **SME target (Art. 33)** | 25 % of innovative procurement to innovative SMEs | **SME integrators** |
| **Private sector (Art. 31)** | Voluntary assessment in NIS2 sectors; possible obligation | **Critical-customer integrators** |

**TAKEAWAY** The channel that reads the risk assessments before the competition will reach the tender with the configuration already validated.

Source: [R1] Arts. 29–33; [R3] activeMind.

## Open source

Articles 41 to 44 require the promotion of open standards and open-source components in the public cloud and AI ecosystem, the sharing of software developed for the administration in a catalogue connected to the EU's, and the creation of a network of open source programme offices (OSPOs) [R1]. Free software associations criticise the fact that the Strategy's "open source first" principle has been reduced to an obligation to promote [R32].

## What changes in the market

Centralised procurement concentrates volume in large lots that favour those with scale, and the public federation may shift the opportunity from infrastructure to the services delivered on top of it (migration, integration, applications, support). Open source redistributes value towards those who know how to deploy, integrate, maintain and secure open solutions.

## What it means for the value chain

For vendors, the large European and national framework agreements will require presence in lots with uniform conditions; working through a distributor with tendering and financing capacity makes that presence easier. For integrators, the realistic path is twofold: to be specialist partners of the winners of the large lots, and to develop a line of services based on open components that can be offered at higher levels. For the value-added distributor, the opportunity lies in aggregation: submitting multi-vendor bids for framework agreements, supporting its integrators in regional lots and expanding its catalogue of open solutions with enterprise support (for example, virtualisation platforms, software-defined storage or Kubernetes stacks with commercial support), an area where distributors are already adding vendors such as Canonical or Trilio [R19].

> **Centralised procurement concentrates volume; open source redistributes it. The channel must be in both circuits: as an aggregator in the large lots and as a specialist in supported open solutions.**

| Instrument | Articles | Key figure | Effect for the channel |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Joint procurement** | 37–40 | Fee ≈ 2 %; ≈ EUR 6m/year | Large lots, aggregated bids |
| **EuroCloud Federation** | 34–36 | EUR 75,000 → EUR 30,000 per member | Shared public infrastructure |
| **Open source** | 41–44 | EU catalogue; OSPO network | Support and integration of open solutions |
| **SMEs** | 33 | 25 % target | Access for SME integrators |

INFOGRAPHIC 09 · JOINT PROCUREMENT AND OPEN SOURCE

## Centralised procurement concentrates volume and open source redistributes it: the channel must be in both

Instruments in Articles 33–44 and their effect on vendors, distributors and integrators

### Central purchasing (37–40)

**GAIN**
Large lots with ≈ 2 % fee; aggregated multi-vendor bids.

**BRAKE**
Favours scale; SMEs end up as subcontractors.

### EuroCloud Federation (34–36)

**GAIN**
Services on shared public infrastructure: migration, applications, support.

**BRAKE**
Part of the infrastructure is no longer procured from the market.

### Open source (41–44)

**GAIN**
Support, integration and security of open solutions; EU catalogue.

**BRAKE**
Obligation to promote, not to prefer.

### SME target (33)

**GAIN**
25 % of innovative procurement for innovative SMEs.

**BRAKE**
Requires proof of innovation.

### EU added value (32)

**GAIN**
Points for EU-made technology and hardware.

**BRAKE**
Non-decisive criterion.

### Distributor's role

**GAIN**
Aggregate vendors, finance and support regional lots.

**BRAKE**
Requires tendering capacity.

**TAKEAWAY** Aggregator in large lots and specialist in supported open solutions: two complementary positions for the channel.

Source: [R1] Arts. 32–44; [R32] CNLL; [R31] MBB; [R19] distributor press releases.

# 10. The AI Act and the CADA: doubly compliant AI through the channel

## Two regulations, one value chain

The AI Act (Regulation (EU) 2024/1689) regulates how AI systems and models are developed, placed on the market and used according to their risk; the CADA regulates the infrastructure on which they run and the sovereignty conditions under which the public sector procures them. The former answers "what AI can do and with what safeguards"; the latter, "where it runs and under whose control" [R33].

## The AI Act after the Omnibus

The Digital Omnibus on AI reached a provisional agreement on 7 May 2026: it postpones the obligations for Annex III high-risk systems to 2 December 2027 (and those for regulated products to 2028), delays the marking of AI-generated content for systems already on the market, adds prohibitions and extends simplifications to mid-cap companies [R34]. Since 2 August 2026, the AI Office and national authorities have had supervisory powers [R33].

## Points of contact

- Training data: CADA level 2 prohibits service data from training AI of third-country entities, which adds to the AI Act's data governance requirements.
- Evidence: criterion F of Annex III (MLOps in the EU, model cards, lineage) overlaps with the AI Act's technical documentation for high-risk systems.
- Public sector: many public uses of AI are high-risk under the AI Act and, at the same time, public-order activities under the CADA.
- Consistency: the EDPS has called for explicit consistency between the two regulations [R25].

## Generative AI as a cloud service

Assistants and models consumed via API are cloud services for public procurement purposes. A body wishing to use a language model in public-order activities will need the service to be at level 2 or higher. This favours deployments of open models on European infrastructure or on the customer's own premises, and explains the growing interest in sovereign AI servers and appliances.

## The channel as the route for local AI

This point connects directly with the value-added distributor's business. AI run on premises or in a European data centre requires servers with accelerators, high-performance storage, low-latency networking, power and cooling, as well as orchestration, observability and security software. This is infrastructure sold through the channel. NVIDIA, for example, structures its European presence through specialist distributors and partners: TD SYNNEX was named NVIDIA's EMEA distributor of the year in 2026 for enabling local "AI Factory" solutions for proofs of concept [R35], and the partners of the year include specialists from southern Europe [R36]. In Iberia, distributors are already creating dedicated units to train and support partners in AI [R21].

### What it means for each player

Vendors of servers, accelerators and AI software will need to provide their partners with documentation useful for both regulations: where telemetry and updates are processed, what remote functions exist and how it is guaranteed that customer data is not used to train third-party models. Integrators that build AI into their solutions (ERP assistants, machine vision on the shop floor, document classification, biometrics) will have to classify each feature by risk under the AI Act and know where it runs under the CADA. The value-added distributor can offer "doubly compliant AI" reference configurations: validated hardware and software, run on European infrastructure, with the documentation needed for the AI Act and for the sovereignty file.

> **What the AI Act asks to be documented about data and models is, to a large extent, what the CADA asks to be demonstrated about where they are processed. A single AI and data governance framework, prepared in the channel, saves work on both fronts.**

| Aspect | AI Act | CADA |
|---|---|---|
| **Subject matter** | AI systems and models | Cloud services and infrastructure |
| **Approach** | Risk to health, safety and rights | Sovereignty, resilience and public order |
| **Obligated parties** | Providers and deployers | Public sector; providers seeking recognition |
| **Key date** | High-risk: 2-12-2027 | Application ≈ one year after entry into force |
| **Proof** | Technical documentation and conformity | Annex III evidence and audit |

## 11. The Data Act: provider switching and migrations as a business line

### The foundation of cloud competition

The Data Act (Regulation (EU) 2023/2854) has applied since 12 September 2025. Its Chapter VI regulates switching between data processing service providers: transparency, deadlines, interoperability and the gradual elimination of switching charges, which could only reflect direct costs until 12 January 2027 and are prohibited thereafter, except for early termination penalties [R37]. It also regulates access to data from connected products and safeguards against third-country governmental access to non-personal data.

### Support instruments

In November 2025 the Commission published model contractual terms and standard contractual clauses for cloud contracts, ready to be inserted [R38]. The Digital Omnibus proposes integrating other data rules into the Data Act and adjusting provider switching for custom-built services and older SME contracts [R39].

INFOGRAPHIC 10 · AI ACT AND CADA

## Sovereign AI is sold through the channel: servers, GPUs, storage and software run in the EU

Two complementary regulations on the same value chain

**AI Act · what AI can do**

- Risk classification of each system
- High risk: 2-12-2027 after the Omnibus
- Technical documentation, data, human oversight
- AI Office with powers since 2-8-2026

**CADA · where it runs and under whose control**

- Level 2+: data does not train third-country AI
- Criterion F: MLOps in the EU, model cards, lineage
- AI APIs for public order: level 2 or higher
- Favours open models on EU infrastructure

**Doubly compliant AI: models on European infrastructure with an accredited level and AI Act documentation included.**

LOCAL AI REFERENCE CONFIGURATION (PROPOSAL)

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Application** | INTEGRATOR | Assistants, machine vision, document classification |
| **Models** | SOFTWARE | Open models, orchestration, MLOps in the EU, logs |
| **Compute** | VENDOR | Accelerated servers, fast storage, network |
| **DC** | OPERATOR | Local, regional or AI-ready colocation data centre |
| **Integration** | DISTRIBUTOR | Validated configuration, financing, training |

**TAKEAWAY** What the AI Act asks to be documented about data and models is largely what the CADA asks to be proven about where they are processed.

Source: [R33] AI Act; [R34] Omnibus; [R1] Annex III F; [R21] El Español; [R35] TD SYNNEX/NVIDIA.

## How it fits with the CADA

- The Data Act makes it easier to leave a provider; the CADA creates reasons to do so in the public sector, with migrations of up to twelve months where the risk assessment requires it.
- Recognition of third countries under the CADA requires the absence of controls incompatible with the Data Act's provisions on access to non-personal data.
- The Data Act's interoperability reduces the technological lock-in that the CADA seeks to correct.

## The connected product also belongs to the channel

The Data Act is not just a cloud regulation. Vendors of connected products (industrial equipment, IoT devices, printers, uninterruptible power supplies, cloud-managed network equipment) must allow users to access the data they generate. Many of these products are sold through the channel, and the integrator is the one who installs and configures them. Contracts, documentation and management portals must reflect those rights.

## A wave of migrations

In practice, switching provider remains costly on platforms and applications with proprietary data and logic. If the CADA risk assessments arrive in 2029 and require migration within twelve months, a wave of simultaneous migrations may occur that strains the capacity of integrators and destination providers (our own analysis).

## What it means for the value chain

For integrators, the combination of the Data Act and the CADA opens up a service line: planning and executing compliant provider switches, with an inventory of exportable data, mapping of customisations, new contractual clauses, portability tests and documentation for the sovereignty file. For infrastructure vendors, every migration from the public cloud to private, hybrid or sovereign environments is an opportunity to sell servers, storage, and virtualisation and data protection software. For the value-added distributor, which distributes data protection, observability and storage platforms, the challenge is to package those migrations into reference offers, with financing so that the customer does not have to bear the entire investment at once.

> **The Data Act is the emergency exit that makes the CADA's requirements credible. The channel that masters both regulations will sell secure migrations, not just licences or equipment.**

| Data Act obligation | Date | Link with the CADA |
|---|---|---|
| **General application** | 12-9-2025 | Contractual basis of the cloud market |
| **Switching charges limited to direct costs** | Until 12-1-2027 | Makes earlier migrations cheaper |
| **Switching with no charges** | From 12-1-2027 | Facilitates migrations required by Art. 29 |
| **Earlier contracts** | From 12-9-2027 | Review of existing contracts |
| **Third-country access to non-personal data** | In force | Condition for recognising third countries |

# 12. Cybersecurity: NIS2, CSA2, EUCS and the CRA in the distribution chain

## The layer on which the CADA rests

Levels 2 to 4 require a European cybersecurity certificate at "substantial" or "high" level. It was supposed to come from the European cloud certification scheme (EUCS), blocked for years by disagreement over sovereignty requirements. The CADA takes sovereignty out of the technical scheme, but still needs a certificate; until one exists, national schemes or certificates aligned with CEN/TS 18026:2024 will apply [R1][R40].

## The Cybersecurity Act 2

On 20 January 2026 the Commission proposed replacing the Cybersecurity Act with a new regulation (CSA2) with a strengthened ENISA mandate, a more agile certification framework and a horizontal ICT supply chain security framework that allows high-risk third-country suppliers to be designated and their components to be removed from key assets, with fines of up to 7 % of global turnover [R40]. For vendors, this designation is a direct commercial risk; for the channel, it is one more reason to diversify the catalogue.

## NIS2

The NIS2 Directive includes cloud providers, data centres and managed service providers as digital infrastructure entities, subject to risk management, incident notification and supply chain security [R41]. Spain has not yet completed transposition: the Commission referred it to the Court of Justice in July 2026 and, with the dissolution of Parliament (Cortes), the law has been left for the next legislature [R42]; distributors are already seeing its pull effect on security investment and are training the channel in these frameworks [R43].

## Cyber Resilience Act: obligations for importers and distributors

The Cyber Resilience Act (CRA) imposes requirements on products with digital elements, both hardware and software. From 11 September 2026 manufacturers must report actively exploited vulnerabilities and severe incidents; the remaining obligations, including the SBOM, apply from 11 December 2027 [R44]. The CRA also assigns obligations along the chain: the importer must check that the manufacturer has carried out the conformity assessment and that technical documentation and CE marking exist; the distributor must verify the marking and documentation before making the product available, not sell products it knows to be non-compliant and inform the manufacturer and the authorities when it detects risks [R45]. A distributor importing products from non-European vendors may take on the role of importer.

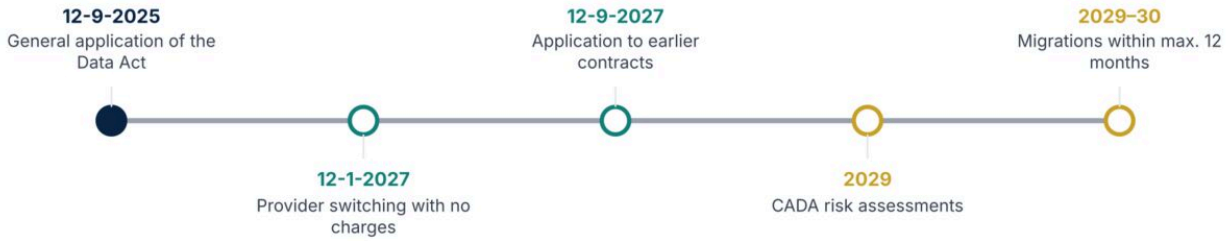
## The certification bottleneck

Dependence on a European scheme that does not exist is probably the CADA's greatest technical risk. If it is not ready, each Member State will accept its own schemes (SecNumCloud in France, C5 in Germany, ENS in Spain), with a risk of fragmentation and limited evaluator capacity in the early years.

INFOGRAPHIC 11 · DATA ACT

## The Data Act is the emergency exit that makes the CADA credible: migrations will be channel business

Provider switching dates and anatomy of a compliant migration




Done · Planned · Scenario / estimate

COMPLIANT MIGRATION: WHO DOES WHAT




**RISK** If many administrations migrate at once in 2029–2030, integrator and destination capacity may saturate: plan early.

Source: [R37] Data Act; [R38] model clauses; [R1] Art. 29; migration wave: our own analysis.

### What it means for the value chain

Vendors must simultaneously prepare CRA conformity, the supply chain documentation required by the CADA and their exposure to possible designation as a high-risk supplier under the CSA2. A value-added distributor with a broad cybersecurity portfolio and a specialist unit can offer integrators a single control framework aligning the ENS, NIS2, the CRA and the CADA, and verify in its product onboarding process that each SKU complies with the CRA. Integrators, in turn, can turn this framework into managed security services: according to Omdia, more than 90 % of cybersecurity sales go through the channel [R12].

> **CADA sovereignty rests on a certification that does not yet exist at European scale, and the CRA turns the distributor into a conformity control link. Both facts reinforce the value of the specialist distributor.**

| Regulation | Status (Nov 2026) | Relevant requirement for the channel |
|---|---|---|
| **NIS2** | Transposition pending in Spain | Supply chain, notification |
| **CSA2** | Proposal (Jan 2026) | High-risk suppliers |
| **EUCS** | Blocked | Basis for the "substantial"/"high" certificate |
| **CRA** | Reporting from 11-9-2026; rest 11-12-2027 | Importer and distributor obligations; SBOM |
| **ENS (Spain)** | In force (RD 311/2022) | Certification of conformity for public suppliers |

## 13. DORA, the DMA and the reshaping of cloud programmes

### DORA and the oversight of technology providers

DORA is the first European regime to directly oversee technology providers. On 18 November 2025 the European supervisory authorities designated 19 critical ICT third-party providers, including AWS, Google Cloud, Microsoft, Oracle and SAP, operators such as Orange and Deutsche Telekom and consultancies such as Accenture, Capgemini or NTT DATA [R46]. Financial entities must include clauses on location, access, audit and exit in their contracts.

### The DMA: AWS and Azure as gatekeepers

On 25 June 2026 the Commission communicated its preliminary conclusion that AWS and Azure should be designated as gatekeepers under the Digital Markets Act; if confirmed, they will have six months to comply with interoperability, portability and non-self-preferencing obligations [R47]. This may change licensing conditions and the ability to run software on third-party clouds, which also concerns the partners that sell that software.

### Hyperscaler programmes are already changing

Regardless of regulation, the large providers are reshaping their relationship with the channel:

INFOGRAPHIC 12 · CYBERSECURITY

## The CRA makes the distributor a conformity control link, and the CADA depends on a certificate that does not yet exist

Cybersecurity regulations underpinning the CADA and obligations by link

| Regulation | Status (Nov 2026) | Relevant requirement |
|---|---|---|
| CADA levels 2–4 | Proposal | EU "substantial" or "high" certificate |
| EUCS | Blocked | Technical basis of the cloud certificate |
| CSA2 | Proposal (Jan 2026) | High-risk suppliers; fines up to 7 % |
| NIS2 | Transposition pending in Spain | Supply chain and notification |
| CRA | Reporting from 11-9-2026; rest 11-12-2027 | SBOM; importer and distributor obligations |
| ENS | In force (RD 311/2022) | Key to the Spanish public market |

CRA OBLIGATIONS BY LINK

| | Vendor | Importer | Distributor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Conformity assessment and CE marking | High | Medium | Low |
| Technical documentation and SBOM | High | Medium | Low |
| Verify marking and documentation before selling | — | High | High |
| Do not sell non-compliant products | High | High | High |
| Report risks to vendor and authorities | Medium | High | High |

**TAKEAWAY** A single ENS + NIS2 + CRA + CADA control framework, maintained in the channel, cuts costs for vendors, distributor and integrators.

Source: [R41] NIS2; [R40] CSA2/EUCS; [R44] CRA; [R45] DEKRA; [R43] Newsbook.

- Microsoft tightened authorisation for the Cloud Solution Provider programme, with thresholds of USD 1 million in revenue for direct-bill partners and USD 30 million for indirect providers [R48], and has turned its marketplace into a route to market through the channel, with "resale enabled offers" generally available since November 2025 and multiparty private offers available in 30 European markets since May 2026 [R49][R50].
- In January 2026 Broadcom closed the VMware cloud service provider programme to many small European partners, and CISPE lodged a complaint with the Commission [R51].
- According to Omdia, partners will generate 59 % of hyperscaler marketplace sales by 2030 [R52].

### What it means for the value chain

The regulatory squeeze (DMA, DORA, Data Act and CADA) is pushing towards architectures with more deployment options. For software vendors, this requires licences that allow their products to run on European infrastructure and in customer environments. For integrators working with banking, insurance or fintech, it means answering DORA and CADA questionnaires with a single evidence package. For the value-added distributor, the reshaping of cloud programmes cuts both ways: Microsoft's thresholds and the closure of the VMware programme concentrate business in distributors with scale, and virtualisation and private cloud alternatives generate demand for new platforms, training and migration.

> **The CADA does not act alone: the DMA, DORA, the Data Act and the changes to hyperscaler programmes all push in the same direction. The distributor with scale and an alternative catalogue gains relevance.**

| Instrument | Fact | Effect for the channel |
|---|---|---|
| **DORA** | 19 critical providers designated (Nov 2025) | Exit and audit clauses in the financial sector |
| **DMA** | Preliminary conclusion on AWS and Azure (Jun 2026) | Licensing and interoperability |
| **Microsoft CSP** | USD 1m and USD 30m thresholds | Concentration in distributors with scale |
| **Microsoft Marketplace** | Resale and multiparty offers in 30 markets | Software sales through the channel |
| **Broadcom/VMware** | Closure of the VCSP programme (Jan 2026) | Demand for alternatives and migration |

## 14. Data and data spaces: Data Union Strategy, Simpl, EHDS and Gaia-X

### The data strategy behind the CADA

The Data Union Strategy, presented on 19 November 2025, steers data policy towards implementation: more access to quality data for AI, simpler rules and protection of sovereignty. It includes "Data Labs" connecting the common data spaces with the AI Factories and a EUR 100 million boost for data spaces from 2026, and lists the CADA among its flagship actions [R53].

INFOGRAPHIC 13 · DORA, DMA AND CLOUD PROGRAMMES

## Regulation and vendors push the same way: cloud business concentrates in distributors with scale and an alternative catalogue

2025–2026 moves changing how cloud is sold through the channel

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **DORA (Nov 2025)**<br>19 critical ICT providers designated; location, audit and exit clauses in the financial sector. | Banking, insurance |
| 2 | **DMA (Jun 2026)**<br>Preliminary conclusion: AWS and Azure should be gatekeepers; interoperability and licensing. | More deployment options |
| 3 | **Microsoft CSP**<br>Thresholds of USD 1m for direct partners and USD 30m for distributors. | Concentration |
| 4 | **Microsoft Marketplace**<br>Resale enabled offers (Nov 2025) and multiparty offers in 30 European markets (May 2026). | Channel sales |
| 5 | **Broadcom / VMware**<br>VCSP programme closed to many European partners (Jan 2026); CISPE complaint. | Demand for alternatives |
| 6 | **Marketplaces in 2030**<br>Partners will generate 59 % of hyperscaler marketplace sales. | Software opportunity |

**TAKEAWAY** The distributor with the scale to meet the thresholds and an alternative virtualisation and private cloud catalogue gains relevance.

Source: [R46] DORA; [R47] DMA; [R48] CSP; [R49][R50] Marketplace; [R51] Broadcom; [R52] Omdia.

## Data space infrastructure

The common European data spaces (health, mobility, energy, industry, agriculture, finance, public administration, procurement) rely on the Data Spaces Support Centre, on Simpl, the Commission's open middleware, and on industry specifications: the IDSA Dataspace Protocol, the Eclipse Dataspace components and the Gaia-X trust framework [R54][R30].

## EHDS

The European Health Data Space (Regulation (EU) 2025/327) regulates the primary and secondary use of health data; the Commission must adopt its main implementing acts before 26 March 2027 [R55]. Health data access bodies and secure processing environments are likely to be public-order activities under the CADA, requiring level 2 or higher.

## Federation versus centralisation

Data spaces are federated: data remains at source and is shared under machine-readable usage policies, with connectors and verifiable credentials. This fits with the CADA because it reduces the need to concentrate data on large platforms and allows different assurance levels to be applied to each node.

## A data space node is infrastructure

Each data space participant needs a connector deployed on its own or trusted infrastructure, with identity, storage, security and monitoring. For the channel, this means demand for edge servers, secure storage and operation services, especially in industry, health, logistics and energy, where integrators already have customers.

## What it means for the value chain

Infrastructure vendors can work with their distributor to prepare data space node configurations (server, storage, security and open software) ready for integrators to deploy. Integrators with sector-specific solutions are sitting on data that is valuable for industrial, health or circular economy data spaces and can offer their customers participation with sovereignty guarantees. The team that authored this report has taken part in three federated data space demonstrators funded by Spain's Secretariat of State for Digitalisation (health, public procurement and circular economy), experience that can be transferred to the channel's customers.

> **Data spaces are the "data" version of the sovereignty the CADA applies to the cloud: federation, control at source and verifiable trust, deployed by the channel.**

| Component | Status | Role in a channel offer |
|---|---|---|
| **Data Union Strategy** | Communication (Nov 2025) | Political priority and funding |
| **Simpl** | Open middleware being rolled out | Common technical basis |
| **IDSA, Eclipse, Gaia-X** | Specifications and components | Connectors, protocol and trust |
| **EHDS** | Implementing acts 2026–2027 | Demand for sovereign health infrastructure |

# 15. Product regulation that already affects the distributor: WEEE, ecodesign and e-invoicing

## The CADA arrives on an already regulated channel

The technology distributor is no stranger to compliance. Every SKU it distributes must comply with rules on waste, efficiency, product safety and, increasingly, cybersecurity. Understanding these obligations is useful for two reasons: they show that the channel knows how to manage compliance at scale, and they provide processes that can be reused for sovereignty evidence.

## WEEE

In Spain, Royal Decree 110/2015 regulates waste electrical and electronic equipment (RAEE). Producers, including those who import and place equipment on the market for the first time, must register, declare the equipment placed on the market and finance waste management, usually through collective extended producer responsibility schemes; distributors must take back used equipment in certain cases [R56]. The producer's registration number must appear on invoices between producers and distributors. It is an example of how regulation already allocates obligations by link in the chain.

## Ecodesign of servers and storage

Regulation (EU) 2019/424 sets ecodesign requirements for servers and online data storage products, focused on power supply efficiency, active-state performance, material information, and ease of dismantling and secure data deletion for reuse; the regulation is under review [R57]. The review, together with the efficiency targets in Annex I of the CADA and the European data centre energy efficiency package [R58], points to more demanding requirements for the hardware sold to data centres.

## Refurbished equipment

The circular economy is growing in the channel: according to CONTEXT, sales of refurbished PCs through the distribution channel grew by 7 % in the fourth quarter of 2025 in the five largest European markets, and distributors, Esprinet included, have gained weight in this category [R59]. The CADA, which requires secure deletion and asset control as evidence, and ecodesign, which facilitates reuse, push in the same direction.

## E-invoicing

Spain approved Royal Decree 238/2026 on mandatory B2B e-invoicing and Order HAC/1028/2026 regulating the public solution; the VERI*FACTU system has been postponed to October 2028 to align it with the e-invoicing timeline for SMEs and the self-employed [R60]. It affects all the business management software sold by the channel and the invoicing processes of distributors and integrators.

INFOGRAPHIC 14 · DATA SPACES

## Every data space participant needs a node: server, storage, security and connector, deployed by the channel

Components of the European data strategy and how they translate into infrastructure

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Data Union Strategy** | POLICY | Political priority; Data Labs with AI Factories; €100m for data spaces from 2026 |
| **Simpl** | PLATFORM | Commission open middleware for cloud-edge federations and data spaces |
| **IDSA · Gaia-X** | STANDARDS | Eclipse Dataspace, Dataspace Protocol, connectors and trust framework with verifiable credentials |
| **EHDS** | SECTOR | Health data space: implementing acts before 26-3-2027; likely level 2+ |
| **Node** | CHANNEL | Participant's: edge server, secure storage, identity, monitoring and operation |

SECTORS WITH DEMAND FOR NODES AND CHANNEL CUSTOMERS

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Industry** | **Health** | **Logistics** |
| Production data | EHDS | Mobility, supply chain |
| Predictive maintenance, traceability | Secure processing environments | Traceability, footprint |
| **Power** | **Circular economy** | **Procurement** |
| Grids, consumption | Waste | Public procurement |
| Flexibility and efficiency | Product passport | Tender data |

**TAKEAWAY** Data spaces are the "data" version of CADA sovereignty: federation and control at source, on channel infrastructure.

Source: [R53] Data Union Strategy; [R55] EHDS; [R54] Simpl; [R30] IDSA.

### What it means for the value chain

The distributor already maintains, for thousands of SKUs, data on producer registration, efficiency, marking and warranties. Adding a sovereignty sheet (telemetry location, origin of support, components, control) is a natural extension of that system. For vendors, offering WEEE, ecodesign, CRA and CADA compliance in a single package will reduce sales friction. For integrators, equipment retirement, certified erasure and reuse services (ITAD) become part of the customer's sovereign life cycle.

> **The channel already knows how to manage product compliance at scale. The CADA adds one more column to each SKU's datasheet: sovereignty.**

| Regulation | Main obligation | Link affected |
|---|---|---|
| **RD 110/2015 (WEEE)** | Registration, declaration and financing of waste; take-back | Producer/importer and distributor |
| **Regulation 2019/424** | Ecodesign of servers and storage (under review) | Vendor; information to the channel |
| **CRA** | Conformity, marking and verification | Manufacturer, importer and distributor |
| **RD 238/2026 and VERI*FACTU** | B2B e-invoicing; invoicing software (Oct 2028) | Software vendors, channel and customers |
| **CADA** | Sovereignty evidence per service | The whole chain |

## 16. The Spanish and Portuguese framework

### AI governance in Spain

Spain was a pioneer in Europe in creating a national AI supervisory authority, AESIA. On 26 May 2026 the Council of Ministers sent to Parliament the draft Organic Law on the proper use and governance of AI (Proyecto de Ley Orgánica para el buen uso y la gobernanza de la IA), which designated AESIA as the main authority, regulated sandboxes and penalties and included a title on the use of AI in the central government public sector [R61]. The bill lapsed with the dissolution of Parliament on 6 October 2026 (Royal Decree 806/2026), ahead of the general election of 29 November [R42]. Today there is no Spanish AI law: the AI Act applies directly and AESIA continues to operate, but the national penalty regime is missing. The next Government will have to present a new text.

### National Security Framework

Royal Decree 311/2022 regulates Spain's National Security Framework (Esquema Nacional de Seguridad, ENS), mandatory for the public sector and its technology suppliers. Its category system and certification of conformity are today the key to accessing the Spanish public cloud market and the natural basis for future CADA recognition.

INFOGRAPHIC 15 · PRODUCT REGULATION

## The channel already manages compliance at scale: the CADA adds one more column to each SKU's datasheet

Burden of each regulation by link in the chain

| | Vendor | Distributor | Integrator | Customer |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| WEEE (RD 110/2015) | Alto | Medio | Bajo | Bajo |
| Server ecodesign (2019/424) | Alto | Bajo | Bajo | — |
| CRA | Alto | Alto | Medio | Bajo |
| E-invoicing and VERI*FACTU | Medio | Medio | Medio | Alto |
| Data Act (connected products) | Alto | Bajo | Medio | Medio |
| CADA (sovereignty evidence) | Alto | Medio | Alto | Medio |

PRODUCT MILESTONES

| Regulation | Main obligation | Date |
|---|---|---|
| WEEE | Registration, declaration and financing; take-back by distributor | In force |
| Ecodesign 2019/424 | Efficiency, information and secure erasure; under review | In force / review |
| CRA | SBOM and importer and distributor obligations | 11-12-2027 |
| RD 238/2026 | B2B e-invoicing; VERI*FACTU | Oct 2028 |
| Refurbished | Refurbished PCs +7 % in Q4 2025 (5 largest markets) | Trend |

**TAKEAWAY** Offering WEEE, ecodesign, CRA and CADA compliance in a single package reduces sales friction for vendors and integrators.

Source: [R56] ERP Spain; [R57] Commission; [R44][R45] CRA; [R60] CMS; [R59] Newsbook/CONTEXT.

## Digital sovereignty and data centres

On 24 February 2026 the Government presented the Roadmap to accelerate Digital Sovereignty, which places cloud and data centres at its core [R62]. On 27 August 2026 it put out to consultation a draft royal decree on sustainable data centres which, for facilities of 1 MW or more, required at least 80 % of each hour's consumption to be backed by renewables from that same hour and the operator to be established in the EU [R63]. After more than 600 submissions and a critical report from the CNMC on 22 September [R64], the revised text raises the threshold to 10 MW, allows a ramp-up to 80 % hourly renewables until 2031 and focuses sovereignty on data centres hosting public systems in the ENS HIGH category, whose data will have to remain in the EU. The Council of State endorsed it in November with four changes and the Government plans to approve it on 17 or 24 November 2026; as a royal decree, it did not lapse with the dissolution of Parliament [R65]. Part of the industry still opposes it; the Government presents it as a way of managing growth.

## Public programmes and the channel

The experience of the Kit Digital programme, with its network of digitalisation agents, showed that the channel is the most effective vehicle for bringing digitalisation to SMEs and the self-employed: Red.es delivered it through thousands of approved technology providers [R66]. It is reasonable to expect the national cloud and AI strategy required by the CADA to rely on similar mechanisms (our own analysis).

## Portugal

Portugal has a dynamic ICT sector, with more than 13,000 technology companies and around 245,000 professionals, and is consolidating its position as a nearshore services hub for European companies [R67]. For distribution, it is the market with the highest relative growth: the Esprinet Group grew there by 47 % in 2025 and by 37 % in the first half of 2026 [R17][R7]. Portugal will have to designate its CADA authority, adopt its cloud and AI strategy and complete its own transposition of NIS2.

## What it means for the value chain

Spain and Portugal could be among the first markets to apply the CADA swiftly: Spain has an AI authority, a security framework and a sovereignty roadmap. For vendors, ENS certification of their products and services will be a differentiating asset. For integrators, maintaining and raising their ENS certifications and following the future national strategy is a priority. For the value-added distributor, operating with a single organisation in both countries allows it to offer configurations validated for both national frameworks.

> **The peninsula could be an early CADA market: it has a security framework, an AI authority, a sovereignty roadmap and a channel that has already proven its ability to deliver public programmes.**

| Instrument | Status | Link with the CADA |
|---|---|---|
| **Draft Organic Law on AI governance (Spain)** | Lapsed (dissolution of Parliament, 6-10-2026) | Application of the AI Act and public use of AI |
| **ENS (RD 311/2022)** | In force | Technical basis for recognition |
| **Digital Sovereignty Roadmap** | Feb 2026 | Political direction |

| Instrument | Status | Link with the CADA |
|---|---|---|
| **Data centre RD** | Council of State opinion (Nov 2026); approval expected | Energy and sovereignty requirements |
| **Portugal: CADA authority and strategy** | After entry into force | Market with the highest relative growth |

# 17. The European cloud market: dependency, concentration and sovereign demand

## A measurable dependency

European cloud providers went from 29 % of the European market in 2017 to 15 % in 2022, a share that has held steady, while three non-European hyperscalers hold more than 70 % [R1]. Synergy Research data for the first quarter of 2026 put AWS and Azure alone at around 65–70 % of EU cloud revenue [R47].

## Demand that is changing in nature

Gartner forecasts that European spending on sovereign infrastructure as a service will grow from USD 6.9 billion in 2025 to USD 12.6 billion in 2026 and approach USD 23.1 billion in 2027 [R68]. The study commissioned by the Commission for the impact assessment also quantifies the gap between existing computing capacity and projected demand [R69]. This is a structural change in the way of buying. The hyperscalers have responded with "sovereign" offerings and large investments in European data centres, such as the EUR 33.7 billion announced by AWS in Spain [R63].

## Computing capacity for AI

Bruegel stresses that the EU lags far behind the United States in AI chip capacity and warns that strict sovereignty criteria could make capacity more expensive [R70]. Data centres consumed around 68 TWh in the EU in 2024 and their demand could almost double by 2030 [R58].

## What the CADA is trying to change

The CADA does not seek to drive out the hyperscalers, but to create a market segment, the public one and by extension the critical one, where competition is also based on control and resilience. If that segment reaches critical mass, European providers will be able to scale and non-European ones will have incentives to offer European control and operating structures, as some alliances already do (S3NS between Thales and Google, or Bleu between Orange, Capgemini and Microsoft).

## Cloud is not only public

For the channel, one nuance is essential: sovereignty is also built outside the public cloud. Private clouds in the customer's data centre, clouds from regional providers, colocation and infrastructure-as-a-service consumption models (HPE GreenLake, Dell APEX or Lenovo TruScale) make it possible to offer control and localisation with hardware sold through the channel. Much of the sovereign demand will translate into purchases of servers, storage, networking, and virtualisation, data protection and security software, not into hyperscaler subscriptions.

INFOGRAPHIC 16 · SPAIN AND PORTUGAL

## The peninsula could be an early CADA market: it has a security framework, an AI authority and a growing channel

National instruments and market signals in both countries

### Spain

- AESIA; the AI law lapsed with the dissolution of Parliament
- ENS (RD 311/2022): key to the public market
- Digital Sovereignty Roadmap (Feb 2026)
- Data centre RD: 80 % hourly renewables (≥ 10 MW)
- Kit Digital: the channel as a programme vehicle
- Esprinet Spain: +21 % in H1 2026

### Portugal

- More than 13,000 ICT companies
- Around 245,000 ICT professionals
- Nearshore services hub for Europe
- CADA authority and strategy pending
- NIS2 being transposed
- Esprinet Portugal: +47 % in 2025, +37 % in H1 2026

**A single organisation in both countries lets the distributor offer configurations valid for both national frameworks.**

SPANISH INSTRUMENTS AND THEIR LINK WITH THE CADA

| Instrument | Status | Link with the CADA |
|---|---|---|
| **Draft AI Organic Law** | Lapsed (6-10-2026) | AI in the public sector |
| **ENS** | In force | Basis for recognition |
| **Data centre RD** | Council of State (Nov 2026) | Energy and sovereignty |
| **Cloud and AI strategy** | After the CADA | Procurement plans |

**TAKEAWAY** ENS certification of products and services, tracking the national strategy and presence in both countries: the three Iberian levers.

Source: [R61][R63][R62] Spain; [R66] Red.es; [R67] AICEP; [R17][R7] Esprinet; [R42][R65] update 14-11-2026.

### Where the value lies for the channel

The CADA tends to fragment infrastructure (more providers, more levels, more regions), and fragmentation increases the value of those who know how to orchestrate it. For infrastructure vendors, the sovereign segment is an opportunity to win back workloads that had moved to the public cloud. For integrators, the value lies in the services layer: migration, integration, hybrid operation, security and compliance. For the value-added distributor, the opportunity is to aggregate the pieces into reference offers per level.

> **Market concentration will not disappear with the CADA, but a segment with its own rules will open up where size matters less than demonstrable control, and where the channel's hardware and services regain prominence.**

| Indicator | Value | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Share of EU providers in 2017** | 29 % | Explanatory memorandum COM(2026) 502 |
| **Share of EU providers in 2022** | 15 % | Explanatory memorandum COM(2026) 502 |
| **Three non-EU hyperscalers** | More than 70 % | Explanatory memorandum COM(2026) 502 |
| **Sovereign IaaS spending in Europe 2026** | USD 12.6bn (forecast) | Gartner via CSA |
| **EU data centre electricity consumption (2024)** | ≈ 68 TWh | European Commission |

## 18. The IT distribution market in Europe, Spain and Portugal

### Spain: a record year for distributors

According to CONTEXT data reported by Newsbook, distributor business in Spain grew by 15.1 % in 2025 [R6]. The momentum came from equipment refreshes ahead of the end of Windows 10 support in October 2025, from growth in data centre infrastructure and from cybersecurity. The Alimarket 2026 Report lists among the main distributors TD SYNNEX, Esprinet, Ingram Micro, MCR, Riba Mundo Tecnología, Inforpor, Depau, DMI, Infortisa and Globomatik, among others [R15].

### Europe: a more moderate 2026

For Europe as a whole, CONTEXT forecasts IT distribution growth of around 2.1 % in 2026 [R71]. The end of the Windows 10 effect and the memory shortage, which has driven early purchases and is putting pressure on prices in the second half, point to a more uneven year for the workplace segment [R72]. Data centre infrastructure, security and software keep growing.

### The channel is losing share but gaining influence

Omdia estimates that the share of IT spending channelled by partners will fall from 70.1 % in 2025 to 66.7 % in 2026, due to the growth of direct server sales to hyperscalers and of cloud software [R10]. At the same time, absolute spending through partners keeps growing, 82 % of IT spending by SMEs in EMEA goes through them [R11] and cybersecurity depends on the channel for more than 90 % [R12]. At Canalys Forum EMEA 2026 it was warned that up to 30 % of current partners will not exist in their current form by 2030, with growth concentrated in AI, cybersecurity and data specialists [R73].

INFOGRAPHIC 17 · CLOUD MARKET

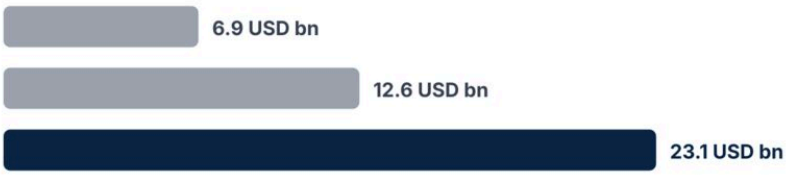
## Dependence on three hyperscalers opens a sovereign segment where channel hardware and services regain prominence

Market shares, sovereign demand and deployment alternatives

SHARE OF THE EUROPEAN CLOUD MARKET




EUROPEAN SOVEREIGN IAAS SPENDING (USD BILLION, GARTNER)




WHERE SOVEREIGNTY IS BUILT

| Model | Examples | Channel role |
|---|---|---|
| **Customer private cloud** | Virtualisation, storage, data protection | Full sale and deployment |
| **Regional cloud and colocation** | Regional colocation operators | Infrastructure and services |
| **Infrastructure as a service** | GreenLake, APEX, TruScale | Pay-per-use sales |
| **Hyperscaler with EU operation** | S3NS, Bleu, Delos | Services on the platform |

**TAKEAWAY** The CADA fragments infrastructure, and fragmentation increases the value of those who can orchestrate it.

Source: [R1] memorandum; [R47] Synergy; [R68] Gartner via CSA; [R20] AI colocation.

### The distributor as orchestrator

The GTDC, the association of the large technology distributors of which Esprinet is a member [R74], argues in its July 2026 report that distribution can raise vendors' execution capacity above 80 % in key go-to-market functions, and that vendors prioritise visibility of return (88 %), strategic alignment (85 %) and partner recruitment and enablement (83 %) [R75]. In Spain, the Newsbook round table on cloud brought together Arrow, Ingram Micro, TD SYNNEX and V-Valley to analyse why the distributor remains essential in the cloud environment too [R76]. The GTDC report of March 2026 stresses that the distributor's value already goes well beyond logistics and credit: multi-vendor integration, subscription and consumption models, and partner enablement [R9].

### What it means for the value chain

The Iberian channel is growing faster than Europe, and the value segment is growing faster than the whole. This provides room to invest in preparing for the CADA. But Omdia's warning is clear: the channel that does not evolve towards services and specialisation will lose relevance. The CADA is an opportunity to accelerate that evolution with a regulatory reason that customers understand.

> **The Iberian channel comes to the CADA on a growth path, but with an underlying message: share is won through specialisation and service, not volume. Sovereignty is a specialisation.**

## 19. Vendor programmes in transformation

### 2026, the year partner programmes were redesigned

Almost all the large vendors redesigned their channel programmes in 2025 and 2026. The changes share three features: fewer tiers and more competencies, incentives linked to value and the customer life cycle, and greater weight for managed services and AI.

### The main changes

- From 1 November 2026 HPE is unifying the HPE and Juniper Networks programmes into HPE Partner Ready Vantage, with a single set of tiers, competencies and compensation, and is expanding the range of products it sells exclusively through the channel [R77]. In Spain, close to 90 % of the opportunities won by HPE Aruba Networking are identified by a partner [R78].
- In February 2026 Cisco launched the Cisco 360 Partner Program: it eliminates the Gold, Premier and Select tiers, creates two categories (Partner and Preferred Partner), measures the value delivered across the customer life cycle and adds specialisations in secure AI infrastructure and secure networking [R79].
- In the first quarter of 2026 Google Cloud launched its Partner Network with Select, Premier and Diamond tiers, competencies based on validated capability and contribution, and a six-month transition [R80].
- Microsoft tightened the requirements of its CSP programme and has brought channel sales to its marketplace [R49][R48].

INFOGRAPHIC 18 · IT DISTRIBUTION

## The Iberian channel is outgrowing Europe, but share is won through specialisation, not volume

Distribution indicators in Spain, Portugal and Europe (2025–2026)

**+15,1 %**
**Distributors Spain 2025**
CONTEXT

**+2,1 %**
**Distribution Europe 2026**
CONTEXT forecast

**+21 %**
**Esprinet Spain H1 2026**
Large Iberian distributor

**66,7 %**
**IT spending via partners 2026**
Down from 70.1 % in 2025 (Omdia)

**30 %**
**Partners that will change form**
By 2030 (Canalys Forum EMEA)

**>80 %**
**Execution with distribution**
Go-to-market capacity (GTDC)

WHAT VENDORS PRIORITISE FROM THEIR DISTRIBUTOR (GTDC, 2026)




**TAKEAWAY** The CADA gives the channel a regulatory reason, which customers understand, to speed up its shift to services and specialisation.

Source: [R6] CONTEXT; [R71] CONTEXT; [R21] El Español; [R10] Omdia; [R73] Canalys; [R75] GTDC.

- Dell presented its 2026 partner programme geared to new opportunities in AI and data centre [R81]; Lenovo describes itself as a channel company and has integrated its PC, server and services offering under a single approach; HP is driving equipment refresh programmes.
- Broadcom closed the VMware cloud service provider programme to many small European partners [R51].

### What they have to do with the CADA

None of these programmes yet includes sovereignty criteria in the CADA sense. But all of them are moving towards measuring the value that the partner delivers to the customer: competencies, services, life cycle. It is reasonable to anticipate (our own analysis) that, once the CADA applies, vendors will add "sovereign deployment" or "European public sector" competencies to their programmes, just as they now add security or AI competencies.

### What it means for the value chain

For vendors, the recommendation is to get ahead: define now which configurations in their catalogue can support levels 1, 2 and 3, and what evidence they will provide to the partner. For integrators, the growing complexity of the programmes makes a distributor that translates requirements, manages certifications and helps meet thresholds more valuable. For the value-added distributor, the opportunity is to become the point where vendors "upload" their sovereignty and integrators "download" it ready to use, with training and certification in its partner academies.

> **Partner programmes already measure competencies and value. Sovereignty will be the next competency, and the distributor that standardises it first will set the format for the market.**

| Vendor | 2025–2026 change | Implication for the channel |
|---|---|---|
| **HPE** | Partner Ready Vantage unifies HPE and Juniper (1-11-2026) | A single programme; more channel-only products |
| **Cisco** | Cisco 360: two tiers and value measurement | Specialisation in secure AI |
| **Google Cloud** | Partner Network: Select, Premier, Diamond | Competencies based on contribution |
| **Microsoft** | CSP thresholds; marketplace sales | Concentration in distributors with scale |
| **Broadcom** | Closure of the VCSP programme in Europe | Demand for alternatives |

## 20. Data centres and AI infrastructure on the Iberian Peninsula

### A wave of investment

According to the Spain DC association, Spain reached 439 MW of installed data centre capacity in 2025 and could attract EUR 66.9 billion of investment and more than 16,000 jobs by 2030 [R82]. Madrid, Barcelona and Aragon concentrate the large projects, with announcements such as AWS's in Aragon [R63]. Portugal attracts large-scale projects thanks to its Atlantic connectivity and renewable energy.

INFOGRAPHIC 19 · VENDOR PROGRAMMES

## 2026 is the year partner programmes are redesigned: sovereignty will be the next competency

2025–2026 changes and their implications for the Iberian channel

| Vendor | Change | Implication |
|---|---|---|
| **HPE** | Partner Ready Vantage unifies HPE and Juniper from 1-11-2026; more channel-only products | One programme; ~90 % of opportunities in Spain identified by a partner |
| **Cisco** | Cisco 360 (Feb 2026): Partner and Preferred Partner; value measurement | Specialisation in secure AI |
| **Google Cloud** | Partner Network: Select, Premier, Diamond; competencies | Rewards validated contribution |
| **Microsoft** | CSP thresholds; marketplace sales | Concentration in distributors with scale |
| **Dell · Lenovo · HP** | 2026 programmes geared to AI, data centre and refresh | More services and specialisation |
| **Broadcom** | VCSP closure in Europe | Demand for alternatives and migration |

COMMON TRENDS

**Fewer tiers**
More competencies
Cisco, Google, HPE

**Value**
Customer life cycle
Outcome-based incentives

**Services**
MSP and AI
New specialisations

OUTLOOK — Once the CADA applies, vendors will add "sovereign deployment" competencies; the distributor that standardises it first will set the format.

Source: [R77] HPE; [R78] Newsbook; [R79] Cisco; [R80] Google; [R48] Microsoft; [R81] Dell; [R51] Broadcom; outlook: our own analysis.

## What a data centre buys

A data centre is not just servers. Its purchasing chain includes power (uninterruptible power supplies, power distribution, backup generation), cooling (air, liquid, rear-door heat exchangers), racks and cabinets, structured cabling and networking, general-purpose and accelerated servers, storage, infrastructure management software, and physical and logical security. Value-added distributors have been working this chain for years: at the Newsbook round table on distributors in the data centre, value-added distributors stressed the need for a multi-vendor offering and financing to cover complete projects [R83].

## Distributor agreements in this field

In 2025 and 2026, value-added distributors strengthened their data centre offering with agreements with rack and cooling vendors, with power and cooling providers for data centres and with AI-ready colocation operators in regional data centres [R19][R20].

## The CADA and regional data centres

The CADA and the Spanish draft royal decree on data centres indirectly favour operators established in the Union, efficient and using renewables. Mid-sized regional and colocation data centres are the natural partners of mid-sized integrators, because they offer proximity, control and local support. But they are also the most exposed to energy requirements that demand high investment.

## AI at the edge and on the customer's premises

Not all AI will go to gigafactories. A growing share of inference will run at the edge (industrial plants, hospitals, logistics centres) or on the customer's premises, for reasons of latency, cost and sovereignty. This is mid-sized infrastructure, sold and installed by the channel.

## What it means for the value chain

For vendors of physical and IT infrastructure, the peninsula is one of the most dynamic markets in Europe; the CADA adds an argument based on efficiency and European hardware. For integrators, regional data centres with an accredited assurance level will be their platform for offering level 2 and 3 services. For the value-added distributor, the combination of a catalogue of physical infrastructure, servers, storage, colocation and financing enables it to offer "turnkey data centres" to regional operators and integrators.

> **The data centre wave is the CADA's first tangible opportunity for the channel: every new megawatt translates into power, cooling, racks, servers and services.**

| Indicator or player | Figure | Relevance |
|---|---|---|
| **Installed capacity Spain 2025** | 439 MW | Starting point |
| **Planned investment to 2030** | EUR 66,900m | Demand for infrastructure |
| **Projected jobs** | More than 16,000 | Need for talent |
| **Data centre RD** | 80 % hourly renewables (≥ 10 MW, ramp-up to 2031) | Efficiency requirement |
| **Distributor agreements** | Racks, digital energy, colocation | Data centre offering |

# 21. Precedents: Commission procurement, SecNumCloud and Deutschland-Stack

## The Commission's Cloud Sovereignty Framework

In October 2025, the Commission launched a sovereign cloud tender for the European institutions worth up to EUR 180 million over six years, evaluated using its Cloud Sovereignty Framework, which measures sovereignty against eight objectives and assigns SEAL levels from 0 to 4, with SEAL-2 as the minimum [R84]. In April 2026 it awarded four contracts: Post Telecom with OVHcloud and Clever Cloud, STACKIT and Scaleway (SEAL-3), and Proximus with S3NS, Clarence and Mistral (SEAL-2). No provider reached SEAL-4, which requires a European chain from chips to software [R84]. CISPE criticised the fact that an offering based on hyperscaler technology could qualify as sovereign [R85].

## SecNumCloud in France

France requires its State Administration to host sensitive data in SecNumCloud-qualified services, ANSSI's framework with requirements for immunity from extraterritorial laws and control of capital; the 2024 SREN Law raised it to statutory status [R86]. Levels 3 and 4 of the CADA reproduce this logic.

## Deutschland-Stack in Germany

In March 2026 Germany adopted the Deutschland-Stack framework, with the open-source Sovereign Cloud Stack as its infrastructure standard, and awarded around EUR 250 million for a federal AI cloud with no US hyperscalers in the winning consortia. The Delos cloud, with Microsoft technology operated by a German company, remains the option for productivity [R87].

## Lessons for the channel

- Sovereignty can be measured and scored: buyers will do so.
- The highest level is almost unattainable in the short term: no provider reached SEAL-4, and CADA level 4 will have very few services.
- Hybrid models will play a role: non-European technology operated by European companies can reach intermediate levels.
- Open source is Germany's route to the higher levels.
- In every case consortia won, not individual companies: operator plus technology plus services.

INFOGRAPHIC 20 · DATA CENTRES

## Every new megawatt on the peninsula translates into power, cooling, racks, servers and channel services

Planned investment and a data centre's purchasing chain

**439 MW**
Installed capacity
Spain, 2025 (Spain DC)

**66.900 M€**
Investment to 2030
Spain DC forecast

**16.000+**
Projected jobs
To 2030

**80 %**
Hourly renewables
RD for DCs ≥ 10 MW (ramp to 2031)

**1,15**
Target average PUE
CADA Annex I

**≈ 68 TWh**
EU data centre consumption
2024; almost double by 2030

A DATA CENTRE'S PURCHASING CHAIN




**TAKEAWAY** Combining physical infrastructure, IT, colocation and financing makes it possible to offer "turnkey" data centres to regional operators and integrators.

Source: [R82] Spain DC via Forbes; [R63] RD; [R1] Annex I; [R58] efficiency; [R19][R20] distributor press releases.

### What it means for the value chain

The Commission's contract winners are consortia combining operator, technology and services, exactly the kind of alliance a value-added distributor can facilitate. For non-European vendors, the Delos, Bleu and S3NS models show that there is room at intermediate levels if they accept European operation and separation of control. For European vendors, the CADA's added-value criterion and the preference shown in these precedents are an advantage. For integrators, the lesson is that competition will take place in consortia.

> **What the Commission is doing today with its own procurement anticipates what public administrations will do under the CADA: score sovereignty, require a minimum and award contracts to consortia.**

| Precedent | Instrument | Outcome | Lesson for the channel |
|---|---|---|---|
| **European Commission** | Cloud Sovereignty Framework (SEAL 0–4) | 4 winners; none at SEAL-4 | Consortia and measurement |
| **France** | SecNumCloud and SREN Law | Obligation for sensitive data | Origin of levels 3–4 |
| **Germany** | Deutschland-Stack, federal AI cloud | EUR 250m with no US hyperscalers | Open stacks |
| **Germany** | Delos Cloud | Microsoft technology operated in Germany | Intermediate hybrid models |

## 22. The debate and scenarios for the size of the sovereign segment

### Those calling for more sovereignty

CISPE considers that the CADA gets the sovereignty architecture right but falls short on procurement, because it does not require European alternatives to be considered, and warns that some clauses allow subcontractors to circumvent requirements [R85]. Free software associations regret that "open source first" has been watered down [R32], and advocates of a "EuroStack" call for an industrial policy covering the entire European technology stack [R88].

### Those warning of the costs

The US technology industry and part of the European one warn of the effect on competitiveness. An ECIPE study commissioned by CCIA Europe estimates a cost of around EUR 115 billion over ten years in its central scenario, with a range of EUR 35 billion to EUR 233 billion [R89]. Bruegel and ICLE point to the risk of making computing more expensive [R70][R90]. These figures should be read with caution: the study is funded by an interested party, and other analyses estimate GDP gains of up to EUR 480 billion in 2030 by combining sovereignty and AI adoption [R89].

INFOGRAPHIC 21 · PRECEDENTS

## In every precedent consortia won: operator, technology and services, the kind of alliance a distributor can facilitate

What the Commission, France and Germany foreshadow

### European Commission · SEAL 0–4

**GANA**
€180m; 4 winners (SEAL-3 and SEAL-2); sovereignty is scored.

**FRENO**
No provider reached SEAL-4.

### France · SecNumCloud

**GANA**
Origin of levels 3–4; legal obligation (SREN Law) for sensitive data.

**FRENO**
Excludes providers under foreign control.

### Germany · Deutschland-Stack

**GANA**
€250m for a federal AI cloud with open stacks.

**FRENO**
No US hyperscalers among the winners.

### Germany · Delos

**GANA**
Microsoft technology operated in Germany: intermediate level.

**FRENO**
Does not reach the highest levels.

LESSONS FOR THE CHANNEL

1. **Sovereignty is measured** — Buyers will score the evidence. → Evidence
2. **Level 4 will be scarce** — Almost no service will reach it in the short term. → Focus on levels 2–3
3. **Consortia compete** — Operator plus technology plus services. → Alliances

**TAKEAWAY** Non-European vendors have room at intermediate levels with European operation; for European ones, EU added value is an advantage.

Source: [R84] Commission; [R85] CISPE; [R86] ANSSI; [R87] Deutschland-Stack and Delos.

### Where the negotiation is heading

Early signals point to a middle ground: softening requirements, clarifying rules for international companies, reducing the Commission's discretion and giving buyers more flexibility [R4]. The four levels and the risk assessment are likely to be retained, the derogations broadened and the recognition of third countries strengthened.

### Three scenarios for the size of the segment

- Soft: level 1 covers most public spending; levels 2 to 4 are a niche in defence, justice, security and health. The main effect is documentary.
- Baseline: level 1 is the general standard and levels 2 and 3 cover health, justice, taxation, security, critical infrastructure and part of the private NIS2 entities on a voluntary basis.
- Strict: broad public categories require levels 2 to 3, the Commission imposes assessments in highly critical private sectors and providers with no European alternative lose public market share.

### What it means for the value chain

The debate defines the size of the high-level market, not the existence of the regulation. The channel's strategy must work in all three scenarios: secure level 1 for the entire catalogue and prepare, with selected vendors, at least one level 2 and one level 3 reference offer in the highest-demand categories (storage and data protection, virtualisation and private cloud, security, local AI).

> **The final CADA will probably be less strict in the details, but it will keep its architecture. Designing the strategy around the architecture reduces risk for the whole channel.**

| Player | Position | Argument |
|---|---|---|
| **CISPE** | More sovereignty and European preference | Avoid sovereignty-washing |
| **Free software associations** | More open source | A genuine "open source first" |
| **ITI and CCIA Europe** | Fewer nationality requirements | Cost and access to technology |
| **ECIPE (commissioned by CCIA)** | High cost | EUR 115bn over ten years |
| **Bruegel and ICLE** | Caution | Risk of more expensive computing |

## 23. Impact on vendors selling through the channel

### A typology of vendors

A value-added distributor's catalogue brings together very different vendors, and the CADA affects them in different ways:

- Infrastructure hardware vendors (servers, storage, networking) headquartered outside the Union: their product is neutral in itself, but telemetry, cloud-based remote management, support and firmware fall within the evidence for levels 2 to 4.

INFOGRAPHIC 22 · DEBATE

## The final CADA will be less strict in the details but keep its architecture: the channel must prepare for all three scenarios

Positions in the debate and likely size of the level 2–4 segment




1. CISPE: European preference
2. Free software: "open source first"
3. **France (SecNumCloud)**
4. ITI and CCIA Europe
5. Bruegel, ICLE
6. **Parliament: soften requirements**

SCENARIOS FOR THE SIZE OF THE SOVEREIGN SEGMENT

| Scenario | Levels 2–4 | Effect for the channel |
|---|---|---|
| **Soft** | Niche: defence, justice, security | **Gains from data centres and level 1** |
| **Basis** | Health, justice, tax, critical | **First wave of tenders 2029–2030** |
| **Strict** | Broad categories; critical private | **Acceleration of sovereign infrastructure** |

**ROBUST STRATEGY** — Level 1 for the whole catalogue and, with selected vendors, one level 2 and one level 3 offer in the highest-demand categories.

Source: [R85] CISPE; [R89] ECIPE; [R70] Bruegel; [R90] ICLE; [R4] MLex. Positions: illustrative.

- Physical infrastructure vendors (power, cooling, racks): low sovereignty impact, high demand and efficiency impact.
- Non-European software and security vendors with cloud services: they are directly affected by data localisation, support from the Union, use of data to train AI and control.
- European software and security vendors: potential advantage from the European added-value criterion and from levels 3 and 4.
- Open-source solutions with commercial support: advantage at higher levels if support is delivered from the Union.

### What integrators will ask of each vendor

- A clear statement of where telemetry, logs and diagnostic data are processed and stored, and whether they can be kept in the Union or disabled.
- Local management options or management from a European region, with no mandatory dependence on cloud consoles outside the Union.
- Second- and third-line support delivered from the Union, with controlled and logged remote access.
- Product SBOMs and a vulnerability management policy compliant with the CRA.
- Clauses guaranteeing that customer data is not used to train AI models.
- Information on ownership structure and on access requests from third-country authorities.

### What risks they face

The main risk for non-European vendors is being excluded from levels 3 and 4 in the most sensitive public activities, and from levels 2 to 4 if they do not offer European support and telemetry. A second risk is designation as a high-risk supplier under the CSA2 [R40]. A third is reputational: if a competitor publishes its sovereignty sheet first, the channel will tend to recommend it.

### What opportunities they have

The vendor that adapts its product (disconnected operating modes, European management regions, support in the Union, software supply chain documentation) can sell more in a market that is fragmenting. Workload repatriation from the public cloud to private or regional environments increases demand for infrastructure. And the data centre wave multiplies demand for equipment.

### How the distributor can help them

The value-added distributor can offer its vendors an Iberian channel readiness service: a sovereignty sheet template per product family, review with its technical team, publication on the partner portal, integrator training, reference configurations per level and presence in public framework agreements. For a vendor without a local structure, this reduces the cost of entering the sovereign segment in Spain and Portugal.

### A sovereignty sheet in practice

The sheet we propose for each product family takes up one or two pages and answers ten questions: the entity marketing the product in the Union; control structure; location of telemetry, log and diagnostic processing; availability of a local management mode or a European region; origin of first-, second-

and third-line support; remote access policy; existence and format of the SBOM; CRA-compliant vulnerability policy; use of customer data to train models; and available certifications (ISO, ENS, national schemes). With those answers, an integrator can tell within minutes whether the product is suitable for level 1, whether it can support level 2 and what it lacks for level 3. For the vendor, filling it in once and keeping it up to date avoids answering hundreds of different questionnaires from its partners.

> **For a vendor, the CADA is not a barrier if it documents early. It is a barrier if it lets its integrators discover in a tender that it cannot provide the evidence.**

| Type of vendor | Impact of the CADA | Priority action |
|---|---|---|
| **Non-EU infrastructure hardware** | Medium: telemetry, remote management, support | Local mode and support from the EU |
| **Physical infrastructure (power, cooling, racks)** | Low on sovereignty, high on demand | Efficiency and European manufacturing |
| **Non-EU cloud software and security** | High: data, AI, support, control | EU regions, AI clauses, separation |
| **European software and security** | Positive | Document European added value |
| **Supported open source** | Positive at higher levels | Support from the EU and SBOM |

## 24. Impact on resellers and integrators

### Who they are

The value-added distributor's customers are resellers, systems integrators, managed service providers and value-added resellers of all sizes: from large consultancies such as SEIDOR, with turnover of EUR 1,174 million in 2025 [R91], or Nunsys Group, with EUR 305 million in aggregate turnover and more than 8,500 customers [R92], to regional integrators such as ACICATECH or INTEGRA and hundreds of technology SMEs. In Spain, the vast majority of partners are SMEs [R13].

### What changes for them

- Commercial: public customers will ask for the assurance level of each service, and level 1 will be the minimum condition for bidding.
- Contractual: contracts with vendors, distributors and subcontractors will have to reflect where data and telemetry are located, who provides support and from where, and what happens in the event of a third-country request.
- Strategic: each integrator will decide which part of its catalogue to take to higher levels, with which vendors and with which data centres.

### Four integrator profiles

- Large national integrator: can build its own level 2 and 3 services, operate data centres or alliances with operators and bid for large lots.

INFOGRAPHIC 23 · VENDORS

## For a vendor, the CADA is a barrier only if it lets its integrators discover in a tender that it cannot provide the evidence

Impact of the requirements by type of vendor in the catalogue

| | Telemetry | EU support | Control | Software chain | AI and data |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Non-EU infrastructure hardware | Medium | Medium | Medium | Medium | Low |
| Physical infrastructure (power, cooling, racks) | Low | Low | Low | Low | — |
| Non-EU cloud software and security | High | High | High | High | High |
| European software and security | Low | Low | Low | Medium | Low |
| Supported open source | Low | Medium | Low | Low | Low |

WHAT INTEGRATORS WILL ASK OF EACH VENDOR

1. **Telemetry and diagnostics** — Where processed; option to keep them in the EU or disable them. — Criterion C
2. **Local management or EU region** — No mandatory dependence on consoles outside the EU. — Criterion C
3. **Support from the EU** — Second and third line with logged remote access. — Criterion H
4. **SBOM and vulnerabilities** — CRA-compliant. — Criterion I
5. **No training on data** — Clause banning use for AI. — Criterion F
6. **Ownership and requests** — Control structure and third-country requests. — Criterion G

DISTRIBUTOR SERVICE — Sovereignty sheet template, technical review, publication, training and configurations per level to enter the Iberian sovereign segment.

Source: [R1] Annex III; [R40] CSA2; [R44] CRA; assessment by type: our own analysis.

- Specialist regional integrator: competes at level 1 and, with partners, at level 2; its advantage is proximity and sector knowledge.
- Managed service provider: its service is the direct object of the CADA; it needs evidence about its own operation (operations centre, access, remote management tools).
- Product reseller: its role is to advise on and supply products whose vendors provide the evidence.

### The risk of being left out

The greatest risk for an SME integrator is that the cost of evidence and auditing for levels 2 to 4 will be disproportionate to its size. If it does not organise itself in alliances or find structured support from its distributor, it may be relegated to subcontractor for large contract winners. This risk coincides with Omdia's warning about part of today's partners disappearing by 2030 [R73].

### The opportunities

- The target of 25 % of innovative procurement going to SMEs [R1].
- The advantage of Article 17(3): an SME's level 1 declaration is valid throughout the Union, making it possible to sell to Portuguese or other Member State administrations without additional recognition.
- New services: sovereignty assessment, file preparation, compliant migrations, data space node operation, local AI.
- Critical private customers that voluntarily adopt the Article 31 assessment.

### What it means for the value chain

For integrators, the value-added distributor can make the difference between being able to offer levels 2 and 3 or not. If the distributor provides validated configurations, vendor sovereignty sheets, training, access to regional data centres with an accredited level and financing, the SME integrator can compete with the large players in CADA-adapted tenders.

### Case study: a regional integrator facing its first CADA tender

An integrator with 60 employees specialising in ERP and managed services for industry and local government receives tender specifications in 2029 requiring level 1 for the main service and level 2 for backup and the recovery environment. It can prepare the level 1 declaration on its own: it is established in Spain, its data is in a national data centre and its subcontractors are declared. For level 2 it needs an operator with an accredited level, products with European support and telemetry, and an audit. If its distributor offers it a reference configuration and an agreement with a regional operator, the incremental cost is limited to the audit of its own operation. If not, it will most likely bid in a consortium with a larger integrator or withdraw from that lot.

> **The SME integrator does not have to build sovereignty alone. It has to know how to choose the products, the data centres and the distributor that allow it to demonstrate it.**

| Profile | Position under the CADA | What it needs from the distributor |
|---|---|---|
| **Large national integrator** | Can build its own levels 2–3 | Volume, financing, complex configurations |

| Profile | Position under the CADA | What it needs from the distributor |
|---|---|---|
| **Regional integrator** | Own level 1; level 2 with partners | Sovereignty sheets, regional data centres, training |
| **Managed service provider** | Direct object of the regulation | Tools with data in the EU, operational evidence |
| **Product reseller** | Adviser and supplier | Clear information per product |

# 25. The value-added distributor as sovereignty orchestrator

## From supply to orchestration

The distributor's historical value has been supply: buying in volume, financing, warehousing, delivering and providing technical support. The GTDC now describes distributors as orchestrators that provide automation, enablement, financing, marketplace operations, compliance support, data analytics and ecosystem coordination [R75][R74]. The CADA adds a new function to that list: organising the chain's sovereignty evidence.

## Five capabilities the value-added distributor already has

- A multi-vendor catalogue in infrastructure, data centre, security, cloud and AI, with hundreds of vendors in the large groups [R16].
- Technical pre-sales and professional services, which make it possible to design configurations per level.
- Training and certification through partner academies and dedicated AI units [R21].
- Financing and credit capacity for infrastructure projects.
- Presence in Spain and Portugal with a single organisation, enabling configurations valid for both national frameworks.

## Five capabilities the CADA calls for adding

- A sovereignty sheet per product family, with data provided by each vendor and translated into the language of Annexes II and III.
- Reference configurations per level (1, 2 and 3) in the highest-demand categories: data protection, virtualisation and private cloud, security, observability and local AI.
- A network of regional data centres and operators with an accredited assurance level that integrators can access (the first distributor agreements with AI-ready colocation operators point in this direction [R20]).
- A recognition support service, with audit and consulting partners.
- CRA conformity verification at product onboarding, in the role of importer or distributor [R45].

## A three-layer service model

This report's proposal (our own analysis) is to organise the value-added distributor's CADA offering in three layers:

INFOGRAPHIC 24 · INTEGRATORS

## The SME integrator does not have to build sovereignty alone: it must choose products, data centres and a distributor that let it prove it

Four integrator profiles facing the CADA

### Large national integrator

**GANA**
Own levels 2–3; large lots; data centres or alliances (e.g. SEIDOR €1,174m).

**FRENO**
Cost of audits and talent.

### Regional integrator

**GANA**
Proximity and sector knowledge; own level 1 and level 2 with partners.

**FRENO**
No structure for complex audits.

### Managed service provider

**GANA**
Its service is a direct object of the CADA: level 2 opportunity in NIS2.

**FRENO**
Management tools with data outside the EU.

### Product reseller

**GANA**
Adviser and supplier of products with vendor evidence.

**FRENO**
Risk of ending up as a subcontractor.

SPECIFIC OPPORTUNITIES

**25 %**
SME target
Innovative buying (Art. 33)

**EU**
SME level 1
Valid throughout the Union (Art. 17(3))

**Art. 31**
Critical private
Voluntary NIS2 assessment

**TAKEAWAY** Validated configurations, sovereignty sheets, training, regional data centres and distributor financing let SMEs compete with the large players.

Source: [R91] SEIDOR; [R92] Nunsys; [R13] Newsbook; [R1] Arts. 17, 31 and 33; [R73] Canalys.

- Information layer: sovereignty sheets, regulatory compliance matrices (CADA, CRA, NIS2, ENS, WEEE, ecodesign) and regulatory change alerts, accessible to all partners.
- Solutions layer: reference configurations per level, with pricing, financing and documentation ready for the file.
- Services layer: specialist pre-sales, training, recognition support and consortium coordination for tenders.

### Why the value-added distributor is well placed

The value-added distributor combines size, specialisation (in the large groups, the value division contributes most of the EBITDA [R18]), growth in both countries and an active policy of agreements with European and non-European vendors in security, data and infrastructure [R19]. This mix allows it to act as a neutral point between vendors of different origins, which is exactly the position needed by whoever organises the sovereignty evidence.

> **The CADA turns supply chain information into a commercial asset. The distributor that standardises it and puts it at the service of its partners becomes the orchestrator of the channel's sovereignty.**

| Layer | Content | Benefit for the partner |
|---|---|---|
| **Information** | Sovereignty sheets, regulatory matrices, alerts | Saves weeks of data gathering |
| **Solutions** | Configurations per level with documentation | Tender-ready offering |
| **Services** | Pre-sales, training, recognition, consortia | Access to levels 2–3 without an in-house structure |

## 26. Opportunities (I): sovereign infrastructure, local AI and data centre

### Workload repatriation

The CADA, the Data Act and the changes in hyperscaler programmes reinforce a trend that already existed: some workloads moving back from the public cloud to private, hybrid or regional provider environments, for reasons of cost, control or compliance. Every repatriated workload needs servers, storage, networking, virtualisation, data protection and security, which are sold through the channel.

### Private cloud and virtualisation alternatives

The closure of Broadcom's VCSP programme and licensing changes [R51] have led many customers and service providers to evaluate virtualisation alternatives and private cloud platforms. For the channel, it is a migration opportunity combining hardware, software, training and services, which can be geared from the outset towards configurations with an assurance level.

INFOGRAPHIC 25 · VALUE-ADDED DISTRIBUTOR

## The CADA turns supply chain information into a commercial asset: the distributor that standardises it becomes the orchestrator

Proposed three-layer service model




THREE SERVICE LAYERS

| Layer | Content | Benefit for the partner |
|---|---|---|
| Information | Sovereignty sheets, regulatory matrices, alerts | Saves weeks of data gathering |
| Solutions | Documented configurations per level | Tender-ready offering |
| Services | Pre-sales, training, recognition, consortia | Levels 2–3 without in-house structure |

**STARTING ADVANTAGE** Multi-vendor catalogue, pre-sales, partner academies, financing and presence in Spain and Portugal.

Source: [R16] Esprinet; [R21] El Español; [R75][R74] GTDC; [R18] Newsbook; layer model: our own analysis.

### Local AI

AI run on the customer's premises or in European data centres is the most direct answer to levels 2 and 3 for AI uses. Vendors of accelerated servers, high-performance storage and low-latency networking, together with orchestration software for open models, make up solutions that the channel can package. TD SYNNEX's experience with NVIDIA, which includes local AI Factory solutions for proofs of concept and the reservation of cloud GPU capacity for its partners, shows that the distributor can be the vehicle for this demand [R35].

### Regional data centres and edge

The wave of data centre investment (439 MW in Spain in 2025 and EUR 66.9 billion planned to 2030 [R82]) generates demand for power, cooling, racks, servers and networking, and the CADA adds a preference for European, efficient operators with European hardware. The edge (plants, hospitals, logistics centres, data space nodes) adds distributed demand that fits the channel's capillarity.

### European and efficient hardware

The criterion of hardware manufactured in the Union, both in strategic data centre projects (Art. 14) and in the European added value of public procurement (Art. 32), may favour vendors with production or assembly in the Union. The review of server ecodesign [R57] and the efficiency targets in Annex I [R1] will reward efficient equipment.

### How to capture it

- Vendors: adapt products to local operating modes and document efficiency and origin.
- Value-added distributors: reference configurations for private cloud, data protection and local AI per level; complete data centre offerings for regional operators; financing.
- Integrators: repatriation projects, migration from platforms affected by licensing changes and deployment of local AI with AI Act and CADA documentation.

### Sizing the opportunity

There are as yet no public estimates of spending on sovereign infrastructure in Spain and Portugal. A prudent approximation (our own analysis, illustrative) starts from three data points: European spending on sovereign infrastructure as a service could almost double every year between 2025 and 2027 according to Gartner [R68]; planned data centre investment in Spain reaches EUR 66.9 billion to 2030 [R82]; and partners channel two thirds of IT spending and more than 80 % of SME spending [R10][R11]. Even if only a fraction of that investment goes through value-added distributors, the potential volume is very significant for the Iberian channel. The priority is not to estimate precisely, but to be in a position to capture the share that will go through the channel.

> **The CADA's first opportunity for the channel is not documentary, it is physical: every workload that returns to a controlled environment needs infrastructure, and that infrastructure is sold through the channel.**

| Opportunity | Driver | Who captures it |
|---|---|---|
| **Workload repatriation** | Cost, control, CADA, Data Act | Infrastructure vendors and integrators |
| **Virtualisation alternatives** | Licensing changes (Broadcom) | Value-added distributors, alternative vendors, integrators |
| **Local AI** | Levels 2–3 for AI, AI Act | Server and GPU vendors, integrators |
| **Regional data centres** | EUR 66,900m to 2030 | Physical and IT infrastructure, distributors |
| **European and efficient hardware** | Arts. 14 and 32, ecodesign | Vendors with production in the EU |

# 27. Opportunities (II): services, compliance, marketplaces and financing

## Evidence and compliance services

The Annex III file requires inventories, data flow maps, subcontractor registers, software supply chain analysis and contract review. Many companies already manage part of that evidence because of the ENS, ISO 27001, the GDPR, NIS2 or DORA. Integrators with a security and compliance line can turn this experience into a recurring "sovereignty file" service, reusable in tenders and audits.

## Managed services

Managed service providers are the fastest-growing profile in the channel and the one the CADA affects most directly, because their service is a cloud service for the purposes of the regulation. With remote management tools that keep data in the Union, security operations centres on the peninsula and evidence about their own operation, they can offer level 2 services to public and critical private customers. The rise of NIS2 and DORA reinforces this line [R43].

## Marketplaces and private offers

Hyperscaler marketplaces are becoming a route to market for the channel: Microsoft already allows resale and multiparty private offers in 30 European markets [R49][R50], and partners will generate 59 % of marketplace sales by 2030 [R52]. For software vendors, publishing versions with a European region and sovereignty conditions on these marketplaces makes it easier to sell to customers with cloud spending commitments. For the value-added distributor, operating multiparty offers adds a software business line that complements infrastructure.

## Financing and consumption models

Level 2 and 3 projects require upfront investment in infrastructure, certification and services. Technology leasing and pay-per-use models (GreenLake, APEX, TruScale and distributors' own schemes) make it possible to spread that investment. The Spanish channel already has experience of financing with specialist partners, and public programmes (Kit Digital) demonstrated the channel's ability to manage grants [R66].

INFOGRAPHIC 26 · OPPORTUNITIES (I)

## The CADA's first opportunity for the channel is physical: every workload returning to a controlled environment needs infrastructure

Five drivers of demand for sovereign infrastructure

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Workload repatriation**<br>Cost, control, the CADA and the Data Act move workloads to private, hybrid or regional environments. | Infrastructure |
| 2 | **Virtualisation alternatives**<br>Broadcom licensing changes: new platforms, training and migration. | Migration |
| 3 | **Local AI**<br>Accelerated servers, fast storage, networking and open models in the EU. | Sovereign AI |
| 4 | **Regional data centres and edge**<br>€66,900m to 2030; plants, hospitals, logistics and data nodes. | Data centre |
| 5 | **European and efficient hardware**<br>Arts. 14 and 32, ecodesign review and Annex I targets. | Efficiency |

WHO CAPTURES EACH OPPORTUNITY

| | Vendors | Distributor | Integrators |
|---|---|---|---|
| Repatriation | High | Medium | High |
| Virtualisation | Medium | High | High |
| Local AI | High | High | Medium |
| Data centres | High | High | Medium |
| European hardware | High | Medium | Low |

**ACTION** Reference configurations for private cloud, data protection and local AI per level, with financing included.

Source: [R51] Broadcom; [R35] TD SYNNEX/NVIDIA; [R82] Spain DC; [R57] ecodesign; [R1]. Assessment: our own analysis.

### Training and talent

The CADA will require profiles that are scarce today: sovereign cloud architects, compliance specialists, software supply chain auditors. Distributor and vendor partner academies can add specific learning paths on sovereignty, the AI Act and the CRA for the channel.

### Consortia and European projects

Calls under the Digital Europe Programme, Horizon Europe, Important Projects of Common European Interest and CDTI and Red.es funding lines will finance pilots of open stacks, data spaces and sovereign AI. SME integrators, with the support of a distributor that provides technology and an adviser on European funding, can take part in consortia that would otherwise be out of their reach. Software in a Box, together with Ullswater Investments, works at this intersection between European funding and technology deployment.

> **The CADA's service opportunities add up: evidence, managed operation, marketplace, financing and training. The ecosystem that offers them in an integrated way will multiply its value per customer.**

| Service | Who provides it | Who enables it |
|---|---|---|
| **Sovereignty file** | Integrator with a compliance line | Value-added distributor (sheets), vendor (data) |
| **Level 2 managed services** | MSP | Vendors of tools with data in the EU |
| **Marketplace private offers** | Value-added distributors and integrators | Software vendors |
| **Financing and pay-per-use** | Value-added distributors and financial partners | Vendors with consumption models |
| **Sovereignty training** | Distributor and vendor academies | Vendors and advisers |

## 28. Regulatory bottlenecks

### The certification that does not exist

The main regulatory bottleneck is the dependence on a European cloud cybersecurity certificate that does not exist. If the EUCS or its successor under the CSA2 is not ready, each Member State will accept its national schemes, with a risk of fragmentation between Spain (ENS), Portugal, France (SecNumCloud) and Germany (C5) [R40]. For a vendor or integrator operating in several countries, this multiplies the cost.

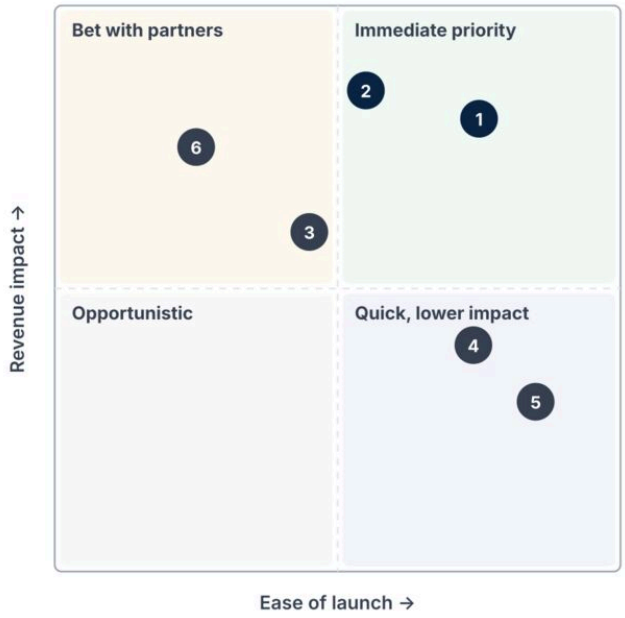
### Untested national authorities

Each Member State must designate a competent authority within one year. If it is created from scratch or with limited resources, the first 12 to 18 months may generate recognition queues, shifting criteria and differences of interpretation between countries (our own analysis).

INFOGRAPHIC 27 · OPPORTUNITIES (II)

## Service opportunities add up: the ecosystem that offers them together will multiply its value per customer

CADA-related services by impact and ease of launch




1. **Sovereignty file**
2. **Level 2 managed services**
3. Marketplace private offers
4. Financing and pay-per-use
5. Sovereignty training
6. Consortia and European projects

WHO DELIVERS AND WHO ENABLES

| Service | Delivers | Enables |
|---|---|---|
| **Sovereignty file** | Integrator with a compliance line | Distributor (sheets) and vendor |
| **Level 2 managed services** | MSP | Tools with data in the EU |
| **Marketplace** | Distributors and integrators | Software vendors |
| **Financing** | Distributors, partners | Consumption models |

**TAKEAWAY** Evidence, managed operation, marketplace, financing and training form a service offering the channel can sell together.

Source: [R52][R49][R50] Marketplace; [R43] Newsbook; [R66] Red.es. Position in the matrix: illustrative.

### Discretion and delegated acts

Annexes II and III can be revised every 18 months by means of delegated acts. This flexibility, which several Member States want to limit [R4], introduces uncertainty: a requirement that allows level 2 today could be tightened. Contracts with vendors and customers must provide for these changes.

### Regulatory overlap

The same evidence will be required by several regulations in different formats: CADA, NIS2, CRA, DORA, AI Act, ENS, Data Act. Without a common control framework, the cost multiplies. In addition, the CRA assigns obligations to importers and distributors that the channel must build into its product onboarding processes [R45].

### Recognised third countries

The list of recognised third countries under Article 18 will decide whether many vendors in the catalogue can aspire to level 3. Until it exists, integrators will not know for certain which products they will be able to use at higher levels.

### Derogations and uneven application

Derogations on grounds of disproportionate cost or lack of supply may become the usual route for some buyers to keep buying what they always have, while others apply the regulation rigorously. This unevenness makes it difficult to plan investments.

### Mitigation from the channel

- A common control framework (CADA, NIS2, CRA, ENS) maintained by the distributor for its partners.
- Contractual clauses for adapting to changes in the annexes.
- Active monitoring of the legislative process and participation in consultations through industry associations.

> **Regulatory bottlenecks do not prevent preparation, but they penalise those who prepare alone. A control framework shared across the channel reduces the cost for everyone.**

| Bottleneck | Probability | Impact for the channel | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Non-existent certification (EUCS)** | High | Fragmentation by country | Start from the ENS and follow the CSA2 |
| **Untested authorities** | Medium-high | Recognition queues | Complete, early files |
| **Changes to the annexes** | Medium | Moving requirements | Adaptation clauses |
| **Regulatory overlap** | High | Multiplied cost | Common control framework |
| **Third-country list** | Medium | Catalogue uncertainty | Alternatives per level |

INFOGRAPHIC 28 · REGULATORY BOTTLENECKS

## Regulatory bottlenecks do not prevent preparation, but they penalise those who prepare alone

Probability and impact by player (qualitative assessment)

| | Probability | Vendors | Distributor | Integrators |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Non-existent EU certification (EUCS) | High | Medium | Medium | High |
| Untested national authorities | Medium | Low | Low | High |
| Changes to Annexes II and III | Medium | High | Medium | Medium |
| Regulatory overlap | High | High | High | High |
| List of recognised third countries | Medium | High | Medium | Medium |
| Derogations and uneven application | Medium | Medium | Medium | Medium |

MITIGATION FROM THE CHANNEL

1. **Common control framework** — CADA, NIS2, CRA and ENS in a single matrix maintained by the distributor. — Shared cost
2. **Adaptation clauses** — Contracts allowing for annex changes. — Contracts
3. **Participation** — Consultations and industry associations during 2027. — Influence

**TAKEAWAY** The ENS is the natural bridge until a European certificate exists: raising it today is the best defensive investment.

Source: [R40] CSA2/EUCS; [R4] MLex; [R45] CRA; [R1]. Assessment: our own analysis.

# 29. Technical and supply bottlenecks

## Memory and prices

In 2026 the memory shortage has driven early PC purchases and is putting pressure on prices in the second half of the year, according to CONTEXT [R72]. Competition for high-bandwidth memory for AI also affects servers and storage. For the channel, this means longer lead times, volatile prices and the need to plan inventory for sovereign projects.

## GPUs and AI capacity

European AI computing capacity is scarce and expensive in the short term, and the acceleration zones will not produce megawatts before 2029–2030 (our own analysis based on [R1][R70]). Distributors are seeking solutions: TD SYNNEX, for example, has reserved GPU capacity with a European cloud provider to give its partners priority access [R35]. Without access to GPUs, the level 2 and 3 local AI offering will be delayed.

## Remote management and telemetry

Many infrastructure and security products are managed today from cloud consoles with data processed outside the Union. Adapting them to local modes or European regions requires vendor development work that may take time. In the meantime, those products can only be used at level 1.

## Software supply chain

The SBOM, control of remote functions and auditing of third-country components are technically demanding, especially in firmware and in products with many dependencies. The CRA makes the SBOM mandatory from December 2027 [R44], which will help, but the depth required by levels 3 and 4 goes further.

## Simultaneous migrations

If risk assessments require migration within twelve months and many administrations do so at the same time, the capacity of integrators, vendors and destination data centres may become saturated in 2029–2030 (our own analysis).

## Energy and permits

The Spanish hourly renewables requirement for data centres of 10 MW or more, with a ramp-up to 2031 [R63][R64], may delay regional data centres that would be the natural platform for the channel's level 2 and 3 services.

## Mitigation from the channel

- Joint inventory planning with vendors for sovereign projects.
- Capacity agreements with regional data centres and European GPU providers.
- A product roadmap from each vendor for local modes and SBOMs, shared with the channel.

> **The most likely technical bottleneck is not the regulation but supply: memory, GPUs, megawatts and local operating modes. The channel that plans with its vendors will have product when the tenders arrive.**

| Bottleneck | Horizon | Effect | Channel response |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Memory shortage** | 2026–2027 | Prices and lead times | Inventory planning |
| **GPUs and AI capacity** | 2026–2029 | Delay to level 2–3 AI | Capacity agreements |
| **Telemetry and remote management** | 2027–2028 | Products limited to level 1 | Vendor roadmaps |
| **Software supply chain (SBOM)** | From 12-2027 | Documentation effort | CRA as a common basis |
| **Simultaneous migrations** | 2029–2030 | Capacity saturation | Early planning |

# 30. Market, margin and talent bottlenecks

## Thin margins and the cost of compliance

Channel margins are thin, especially in hardware [R8]. If preparation for the CADA is treated as a cost rather than a service, it may erode the profitability of distributors and integrators. The key is to turn evidence and support into billable services and a measurable competitive advantage.

## Concentration and consolidation

The European channel is consolidating: acquisitions between distributors, concentration of cloud business in distributors with scale because of Microsoft's thresholds [R48] and warnings that part of today's partners will not exist in their current form by 2030 [R73]. The CADA may accelerate consolidation if only the large players can afford the higher levels.

## Talent

The CADA requires scarce profiles: sovereign cloud architects, compliance specialists and auditors. The data centre sector expects more than 16,000 jobs in Spain by 2030 [R82], and the Portuguese ICT sector is growing strongly [R67]. Competition for talent will make preparation more expensive, especially for the channel's SMEs.

## Large lots versus SMEs

Centralised procurement and large framework agreements favour integrators with scale, while the 25 % SME target and automatic recognition of level 1 favour SMEs. The outcome will depend on how each Member State designs its lots and on whether SMEs organise themselves into consortia.

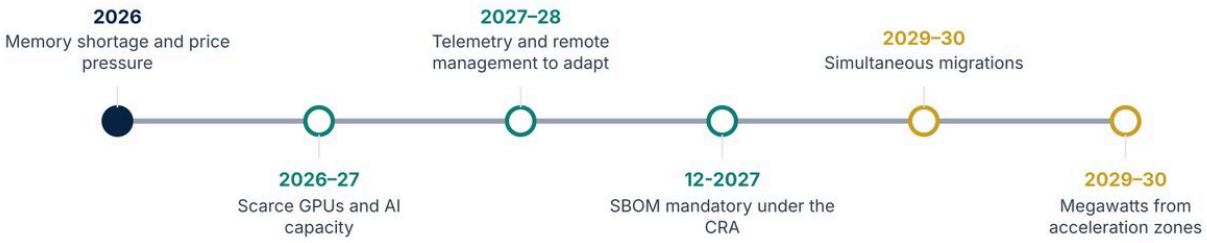
## Channel conflict

Hyperscalers and some vendors are increasingly selling directly or through marketplaces. Omdia estimates that vendors' direct spending will grow almost three times faster than spending through partners in 2026, largely due to infrastructure sales to hyperscalers [R93]. By rewarding control and local support, the CADA may restore weight to the channel in the sovereign segment, but the risk of disintermediation persists.

INFOGRAPHIC 29 · TECHNICAL BOTTLENECKS

## The most likely bottleneck is not the regulation but supply: memory, GPUs, megawatts and local operating modes

Time horizon of the main technical bottlenecks




Done · Planned · Scenario / estimate

CHANNEL RESPONSE

| Bottleneck | Effect | Response |
|---|---|---|
| **Memory** | Prices, lead times | **Plan inventory with vendors** |
| **GPU** | Delay to level 2–3 AI | **Capacity agreements, as other distributors do** |
| **Remote management** | Products limited to level 1 | **Roadmap for local modes** |
| **SBOM** | Documentation effort | **Use the CRA as a common basis** |
| **Energy and permits** | Delay to regional data centres | **Diversify operators** |

**TAKEAWAY** The channel that plans with its vendors will have product available when the 2029–2030 tenders arrive.

Source: [R72] CONTEXT; [R35] TD SYNNEX; [R44] CRA; [R63] RD; horizons: our own analysis.

### Mitigation from the channel

- Billable sovereignty services, with clear pricing and packages per level.
- Shared training across the ecosystem (distributor and vendor academies).
- Consortia of SME integrators for large lots, coordinated by the distributor.
- Channel presence on marketplaces through multiparty private offers.

> **The CADA's market risk is that sovereignty becomes a privilege of the large players. The value-added distributor is the player best placed to prevent this, by sharing capabilities with the channel's SMEs.**

| Risk | Affected | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|
| **Margin erosion** | Distributors and integrators | Billable sovereignty services |
| **Accelerated consolidation** | SME integrators | Consortia and distributor support |
| **Talent shortage** | The whole channel | Shared training |
| **Large lots** | SMEs | Alliances and specialist subcontracting |
| **Disintermediation** | Distributors and resellers | Marketplace and local value |

## 31. Scenarios 2027–2030 and joint roadmap

### Three scenarios

- Soft scenario (medium probability, our own analysis): the CADA is approved with watered-down requirements and broad derogations; level 1 dominates; levels 2 to 4 are a niche. The channel gains mainly from the data centre wave and level 1 documentation.
- Baseline scenario (highest probability): agreement in the fourth quarter of 2027, application in 2029; level 1 as the general rule and levels 2 and 3 in health, justice, taxation, security and critical infrastructure, with voluntary adoption by part of the critical private sector. The channel that has configurations per level and evidence ready captures the first wave of tenders in 2029–2030.
- Strict scenario (low-to-medium probability): high levels for broad public categories and mandatory assessments in highly critical private sectors. Vendors with no European alternative lose public market share and demand for sovereign infrastructure accelerates.

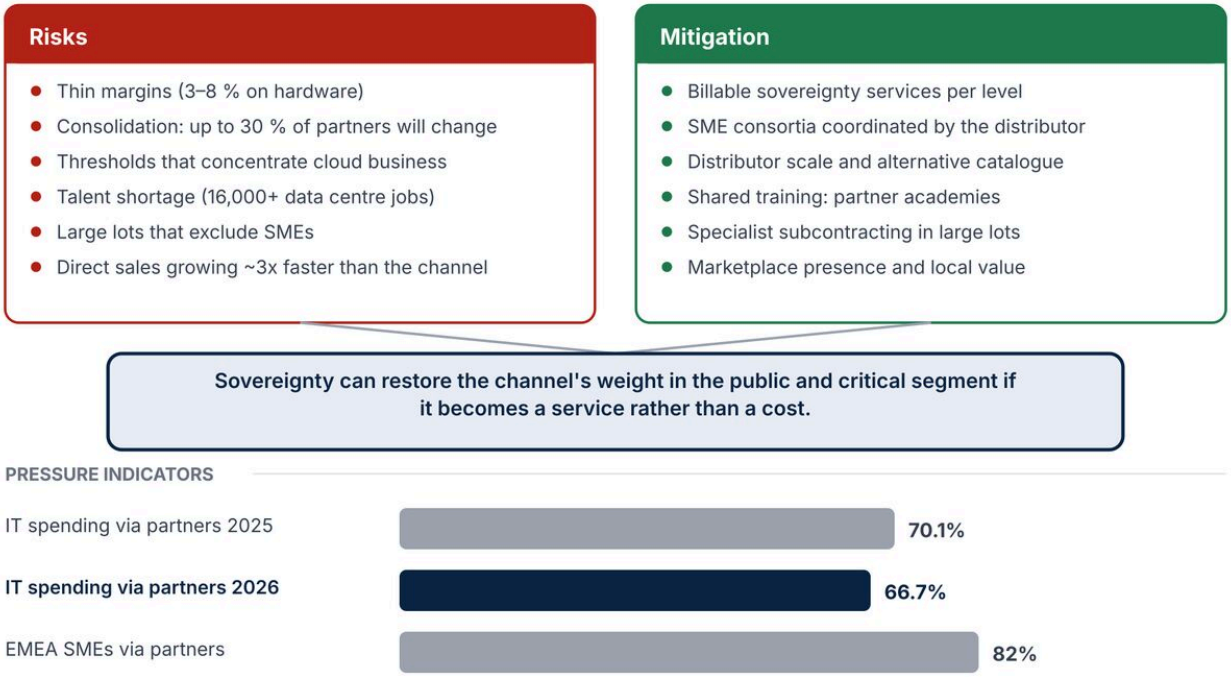
### Roadmap for the value-added distributor

- 2027: create the sovereignty sheet and request it from the main vendors; classify the catalogue by potential level; launch training on the CADA, CRA and AI Act; close agreements with regional data centres.
- 2028: publish level 1, 2 and 3 reference configurations; support the first integrators through recognition; prepare bids for framework agreements.
- 2029–2030: operate the evidence service at scale; coordinate consortia; expand to Portugal and other markets.

INFOGRAPHIC 30 · MARKET BOTTLENECKS

## The market risk is that sovereignty becomes a privilege of the large players: the value-added distributor is best placed to prevent it

Margin, consolidation and talent risks, and their mitigation




PRESSURE INDICATORS




**TAKEAWAY** Specialising in sovereignty is a defence against disintermediation, but only if it is sold as a service.

Source: [R8] Unifyr; [R73] Canalys; [R48] CSP; [R82] Spain DC; [R10][R11][R93] Omdia.

### Roadmap for vendors

- 2027: document telemetry, support, control and software supply chain; prepare CRA conformity.
- 2028: offer local management modes or European regions; support from the Union; SBOM; clauses on not training with customer data.
- 2029–2030: add sovereign deployment competencies to their partner programmes.

### Roadmap for integrators

- 2027: service inventory, dependency map and level 1 self-assessment; decide which services to take to higher levels.
- 2028: prepare the file with the distributor's help; choose data centres; train teams; seek alliances.
- 2029–2030: bid in the first tenders requiring specific levels; offer evidence and migration services to their customers.

> **The roadmap works in all three scenarios because it rests on the stable elements of the proposal: levels, evidence, risk assessment and European added value.**

| Year | Value-added distributor | Vendors | Integrators |
|---|---|---|---|
| **2027** | Sovereignty sheet, catalogue classification, training | Document control, support and telemetry | Inventory and level 1 self-assessment |
| **2028** | Configurations per level, recognition support | Local modes, EU support, SBOM | File, data centres, alliances |
| **2029** | Evidence service at scale, consortia | Sovereign competencies in programmes | First CADA tenders |
| **2030** | Extension to Portugal and other markets | Consolidated tiered catalogue | Migration and evidence services |

## 32. Conclusions and recommendations

### Conclusions

- The CADA organises public procurement of cloud and AI by sovereignty levels and creates a seal that critical private customers will also demand [R1][R3].
- The level is granted to the service, but the evidence is spread across the whole chain: vendor, distributor and integrator. None of them can demonstrate it alone.
- The Iberian channel comes to the CADA on a growth path, with Spain and Portugal above the European average and the value segment growing faster than the whole [R7][R6][R71].
- The first opportunity is physical: data centres, workload repatriation, private cloud and local AI. The second is in services: evidence, managed operation, marketplace, financing and training.

INFOGRAPHIC 31 · ROADMAP

## The roadmap works in all three scenarios because it rests on what is stable: levels, evidence, risk assessment and European added value

Actions for distributors, vendors and integrators 2027–2030

**2027 · Diagnosis**
Prepare

- Distributor: sovereignty sheet and catalogue classification
- Vendors: document telemetry, support and control
- Integrators: inventory and level 1 self-assessment
- CADA, CRA and AI Act training

**2028 · Evidence**
Build

- Reference configurations per level
- Local modes, EU support and SBOM
- Files and choice of data centres
- First recognitions

**2029–30 · Market**
Sell

- Evidence service at scale
- Consortia for framework agreements
- First CADA tenders
- Extension to Portugal and other markets

◆ Gate 1: Political agreement and final text (Q4 2027)

◆ Gate 2: Entry into force and national authorities (2028–2029)

SCENARIOS

| Scenario | Probability (own) | What changes |
|---|---|---|
| Soft | Medium | Level 1 dominates; gains from data centres |
| Basis | Highest | Levels 2–3 in health, justice, taxation |
| Strict | Low-medium | Broad high levels; private entities obligated |

**KEY POINT** Organising together in 2027 and 2028 puts the chain in the front row when administrations start buying by level.

Source: [R1]; [R4]. Scenarios and probabilities: our own analysis, illustrative.

- The most likely bottlenecks are the non-existent certification, untested authorities, the supply of memory and GPUs, energy for new data centres and talent.
- The value-added distributor is well placed to be the orchestrator of the Iberian channel's sovereignty: it has the catalogue, specialisation, presence in both countries, training and financing.

### Recommendations for value-added distributors

- Create a standard sovereignty sheet per product family in 2027 and make it an onboarding requirement for new vendors.
- Launch reference configurations per level in data protection, private cloud, security, observability and local AI.
- Integrate the CADA, CRA, NIS2 and ENS into a single control framework for their partners.
- Expand the network of regional data centres and operators with an accredited level.
- Add sovereignty to their partner academies.

### Recommendations for vendors

- Document telemetry, support, control and software supply chain now, and share it with the channel.
- Offer local management modes or European regions and support from the Union.
- Prepare CRA conformity and the SBOM.
- Design sovereign deployment competencies in their partner programmes.

### Recommendations for integrators

- Inventory their services and self-assess against level 1 in 2027.
- Choose one or two services to take to level 2 or 3 with the distributor's support.
- Turn their compliance experience into a sovereignty file service.
- Explore consortia for large lots and European projects.

> **The CADA will reward chains, not links. Vendors, distributor and integrators that organise themselves together in 2027 and 2028 will be in the front row when public administrations start buying by level.**

| Player | First action (2027) | Expected outcome (2029) |
|---|---|---|
| **Value-added distributor** | Sovereignty sheet and tiered catalogue | Orchestrator of the channel's evidence |
| **Vendors** | Document control, support and telemetry | Products eligible for levels 2–3 |
| **Integrators** | Inventory and level 1 self-assessment | Tiered offering in CADA tenders |

INFOGRAPHIC 32 · CONCLUSIONS

## The CADA will reward chains, not links

Priority recommendations for each player in the value chain

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Distributor · sovereignty sheet**<br>Standard per product family and onboarding requirement for new vendors. | 2027 |
| 2 | **Distributor · configurations per level**<br>Data protection, private cloud, security, observability and local AI. | 2027–2028 |
| 3 | **Distributor · control framework**<br>CADA, CRA, NIS2 and ENS integrated for its partners. | 2027 |
| 4 | **Vendors · document**<br>Telemetry, support, control and software supply chain shared with the channel. | 2027 |
| 5 | **Vendors · adapt the product**<br>Local modes, EU regions, support from the Union, SBOM. | 2028 |
| 6 | **Integrators · self-assess**<br>Service inventory and level 1 for the whole catalogue. | 2027 |
| 7 | **Integrators · choose**<br>One or two services at level 2–3 with distributor support. | 2028 |
| 8 | **All · ally up**<br>Consortia for large lots and European projects. | 2028–2030 |

**FINAL MESSAGE** Vendors, distributor and integrators that organise together will be in the front row of the 2029–2030 tenders by level.

Source: Report synthesis; [R1] and sources cited in each section.

# Annex A. Article-by-article map of the proposal

## How to read this annex

This annex goes through proposal COM(2026) 502 by blocks of articles and indicates, for each one, who is obligated and what it means for the channel: vendors, value-added distributor and integrators. Articles forming a single functional unit are grouped together. References are to the text proposed by the Commission on 3 June 2026 and may change during the legislative process [R1].

## Titles I to III: subject matter, leadership and capacity

| Articles | Content | Obligated party | Implication for the channel |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1–2** | Subject matter, scope and definitions (cloud service by reference to NIS2, assurance level, third-country control) | All | Common vocabulary for contracts and offers |
| **3–4, 6** | Cloud and AI leadership initiatives with general and operational objectives | Commission and Member States | Funding priorities for channel projects |
| **5** | Network of AI Centres built on the European Digital Innovation Hubs | Commission and Member States | SME channel and adoption pilots |
| **7** | National cloud and AI strategy within 12 months, notification within 3 and three-yearly review | Member States | National procurement and adoption plans |
| **8–9** | Priority frontier AI projects with access to computing | Commission | Indirect access to computing via consortia |
| **10–11** | Data centre acceleration zones within 6 months and energy analysis of each zone | Member States | Demand for power, cooling, racks and servers |
| **12** | Single points of information for operators | Member States | Less friction for regional operators that are channel customers |
| **13** | Permitting procedures; maximum 12 months for projects of the highest relevance | Member States | Timeline for new capacity |
| **14** | Strategic data centre projects: 2 of 5 criteria | Commission | Reward for European and efficient hardware |
| **15** | Monitoring of computing capacity and shortages | Commission | Signals of where capacity will be lacking |

## Title IV: sovereignty framework and recognition

| Articles | Content | Obligated party | Implication for the channel |
|---|---|---|---|
| **16** | Cloud sovereignty framework with four levels; Annexes II and III revisable every 18 months | Commission | Tiered catalogue by level |
| **17** | Recognition procedure with fixed deadlines; SME level 1 valid throughout the EU | National authorities | Rapid access to the European public market |
| **18** | Recognition of third countries with six cumulative conditions | Commission | Level ceiling for third-country vendors |

| Articles | Content | Obligated party | Implication for the channel |
|---|---|---|---|
| **19** | Level 1 self-assessment | Providers | Own declaration of conformity |
| **20–21** | Independent audit for levels 2–4 and required evidence | Providers and auditors | Evidence spread across vendor, distributor and integrator |
| **22** | Central repository of recognised services | Commission | Commercial visibility to buyers |
| **23** | Notification of material changes | Providers | Vendors must notify their channel of changes |
| **24** | Effective, proportionate and dissuasive penalties, with no amounts set | Member States | Risk of differences between Member States |
| **25–28** | Competent authorities, powers, mutual assistance and cross-border cooperation | Member States | National point of contact for recognition |

## Title IV: adoption, procurement and open source

| Articles | Content | Obligated party | Implication for the channel |
|---|---|---|---|
| **29** | Public-sector risk assessment within 12 months and every 2 years; migration within a maximum of 12 months | Member States and EU entities | Demand for assessments and migrations |
| **30** | Level 1 minimum; levels 2–4 for public-order activities; limited derogations | Contracting authorities | Entry requirement for tenders |
| **31** | Voluntary assessments for private NIS2 Annex I entities; possible obligation by delegated act | Critical private sector | Extension of demand to the private market |
| **32** | Non-decisive European added-value criteria in innovative procurement | Contracting authorities | Points for vendors with EU technology and hardware |
| **33** | Annual SME monitoring; target of 25 % of innovative procurement going to innovative SMEs | Member States | Advantage for the channel's SME integrators |
| **34–36** | EuroCloud Federation: capacity shared between public bodies | Public bodies | Services on shared infrastructure |
| **37–40** | The Commission as central purchasing body with at least 2 Member States | Commission | Large lots; bids aggregated by the distributor |
| **41–44** | Promotion of open standards and components, catalogue and OSPO network | Public bodies | Support and integration of open solutions |
| **45–48** | Delegated and implementing acts, evaluation after 4 years, entry into force and application | Commission | Timeline and future changes to requirements |

> **Articles 16 to 33 are the ones that decide who sells to public administrations and with what evidence. The rest of the text creates capacity, funding and procurement vehicles that the channel can tap as demand for infrastructure and services.**

INFOGRAPHIC 33 · ANNEX A

## Articles 16 to 33 decide who sells to public administrations and with what evidence; the rest creates capacity and procurement vehicles

Map of the proposal for the channel

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Title I (1–2)** | DEFINITIONS | Subject matter and definitions: cloud service, assurance level, third-country control |
| **Title II (3–9)** | FUNDING | Leadership, AI Centres, national strategies, frontier AI |
| **Title III (10–15)** | INFRASTRUCTURE | Acceleration zones, permits and strategic data centre projects |
| **Title IV (16–28)** | CORE | Levels, recognition, audit, repository, authorities and penalties |
| **Title IV (29–33)** | DEMAND | Risk assessment, procurement rules, EU added value and SME target |
| **Title IV (34–44)** | VEHICLES | EuroCloud Federation, central purchasing body and open source |
| **Title V (45–48)** | TIMELINE | Delegated acts, evaluation and entry into force |

ANNEXES TO THE PROPOSAL

**Annex I**
**Major challenges**
PUE 1.15 and server use ≈ 50 %

**Annex II**
**Requirements per level**
Cumulative from 1 to 4

**Annex III**
**Evidence A–I**
Basis of the sovereignty file

**TAKEAWAY** For the channel, the core lies in Articles 16–33 and Annexes II and III: that is where what can be sold, and with what evidence, is decided.

Source: [R1] COM(2026) 502; [R3] Simmons & Simmons.

# Annex B. Consolidated regulatory and channel timeline 2025–2030

## Why a single timeline

Between 2025 and 2030 the CADA coincides with deadlines under the AI Act, the Data Act, the CRA, NIS2, DORA, the DMA, the EHDS, Spanish legislation and changes to the large vendors' programmes. Vendors, distributor and integrators need a single view to plan investments, contracts and capabilities. CADA-related dates after 2027 are estimates based on this report's baseline scenario.

## Milestones already reached

| Date | Regulation or programme | Milestone |
|---|---|---|
| **12-9-2025** | Data Act | General application of the Data Act |
| **Oct 2025** | Windows 10 | End of support; peak of equipment refresh in the channel |
| **18-11-2025** | DORA | Designation of 19 critical ICT third-party providers |
| **Nov 2025** | Microsoft Marketplace | General availability of resale enabled offers |
| **19-11-2025** | Data Union / Omnibus | Data Union Strategy and Digital Omnibus |
| **20-1-2026** | CSA2 | Proposal for a new Cybersecurity Regulation |
| **Jan 2026** | Broadcom | Closure of the VCSP programme for many European partners |
| **Feb 2026** | Cisco | Launch of the Cisco 360 Partner Program |
| **Q1 2026** | Google Cloud | Launch of Google Cloud Partner Network |
| **24-2-2026** | Spain | Roadmap to accelerate Digital Sovereignty |
| **7-5-2026** | AI Act | Provisional agreement on the AI Omnibus |
| **May 2026** | Microsoft Marketplace | Multiparty private offers in 30 European markets |
| **26-5-2026** | Spain | Draft Organic Law on AI governance sent to Parliament (lapsed on 6-10-2026) |
| **3-6-2026** | CADA | Proposal COM(2026) 502 |
| **25-6-2026** | DMA | Preliminary conclusion: AWS and Azure should be gatekeepers |
| **2-8-2026** | AI Act | Supervisory powers of the AI Office |
| **27-8-2026** | Spain | Consultation on the data centre royal decree (1 MW threshold) |
| **22-9-2026** | Spain | CNMC report on the data centre royal decree |
| **11-9-2026** | CRA | Reporting of exploited vulnerabilities and severe incidents |
| **21-9-2026** | Efficiency | European data centre energy efficiency package |
| **5-10-2026** | Spain | Order HAC/1028/2026 on the public e-invoicing solution |
| **6-10-2026** | Spain | Dissolution of Parliament (RD 806/2026): AI bill lapses |

| Date | Regulation or programme | Milestone |
|---|---|---|
| **26-10-2026** | Spain | Revised text of the data centre royal decree (10 MW) sent to the Council of State |
| **1-11-2026** | HPE | Unified HPE and Juniper programme in Partner Ready Vantage |
| **11-11-2026** | CADA | European Parliament joint draft report |
| **Nov 2026** | Spain | Council of State opinion on the data centre royal decree |

## Upcoming milestones

| Date | Regulation or programme | Milestone |
|---|---|---|
| **17 or 24-11-2026** | Spain | Expected approval of the data centre royal decree |
| **29-11-2026** | Spain | General election |
| **1-12-2026** | CADA | Debate on the draft report in the European Parliament committee |
| **2027** | NIS2 (Spain) | Transposition in the next legislature |
| **12-1-2027** | Data Act | Cloud provider switching with no charges |
| **26-3-2027** | EHDS | Deadline for the main implementing acts |
| **Mar 2027** | CADA | Parliament committee vote |
| **Apr 2027** | CADA | Parliament plenary vote |
| **12-9-2027** | Data Act | Application to contracts concluded before September 2025 |
| **Q4 2027** | CADA | Target for political agreement |
| **2-12-2027** | AI Act | Obligations for Annex III high-risk systems |
| **11-12-2027** | CRA | Essential requirements, SBOM and importer and distributor obligations |
| **2028** | CADA | Publication and entry into force (baseline scenario) |
| **Oct 2028** | VERI*FACTU | Postponed application, aligned with SME e-invoicing |
| **2029** | CADA | General application, authorities and first risk assessments |
| **2029–2030** | CADA | First tenders with levels and peak of migrations |
| **2030** | Market | EUR 66,900m of planned data centre investment in Spain |
| **2032** | CADA | First evaluation of the Regulation |

## Reading the timeline

The timeline shows two workload peaks for the channel. The first, in 2027, combines the Data Act's charge-free provider switching, the AI Act's high-risk obligations and the CRA's essential requirements, with direct obligations for importers and distributors: it is the year to adapt product onboarding processes, contracts and documentation. The second, in 2029–2030, concentrates the application of the CADA, the risk assessments and the migrations. The chain that uses 2027 to build a common compliance framework will reach the second peak with the capacity to meet demand.

> **Two peaks, a single preparation: the evidence system the channel builds in 2027 for the CRA, the Data Act and the AI Act is the basis for the 2028–2029 CADA file.**

# Annex C. Checklist for each player in the chain

## What it is for

Level 1 will be the entry requirement for most of the public cloud market, and levels 2 and 3 will depend on evidence provided by the whole chain. This list translates the requirements of Annexes II and III into practical questions for each player. It does not replace the legal text or the guidance that the Commission and the national authorities will publish [R1].

## Vendor

| Check | Indicative evidence | Criterion |
|---|---|---|
| **Where are the product's telemetry, logs and diagnostics processed?** | Technical documentation and configuration | C |
| **Is there a local management mode or a management region in the EU?** | Deployment guide | C |
| **Can second- and third-line support be delivered from the EU?** | Support contract and escalation matrix | H |
| **Is there an SBOM and a CRA-compliant vulnerability policy?** | SBOM and published policy | I |
| **Is it guaranteed that customer data does not train AI models?** | Contractual clause | F |
| **Are the ownership structure and third-country access requests declared?** | Corporate declaration | G |

## Value-added distributor

| Check | Indicative evidence | Criterion |
|---|---|---|
| **Is there a sovereignty sheet per product family?** | Sheet published on the partner portal | B, C, H, I |
| **Are CRA conformity and marking verified at product onboarding?** | Onboarding procedure | CRA |
| **Are first-line support and spare-parts logistics delivered from the EU?** | Support organisation and warehouses | B, H |
| **Are there reference configurations per level?** | Solutions catalogue | Annex II |
| **Are vendors' material changes communicated to partners?** | Alert procedure | Art. 23 |

## Integrator

| Check | Indicative evidence | Criterion |
|---|---|---|
| **Is the entity providing the service established in the EU?** | Deeds, company register, VIES | A |
| **Are all infrastructure, backups and recovery in the EU?** | Inventory and data centre addresses | B |
| **Do the service's data, metadata and telemetry remain in the EU?** | Flow diagrams and logs | C |

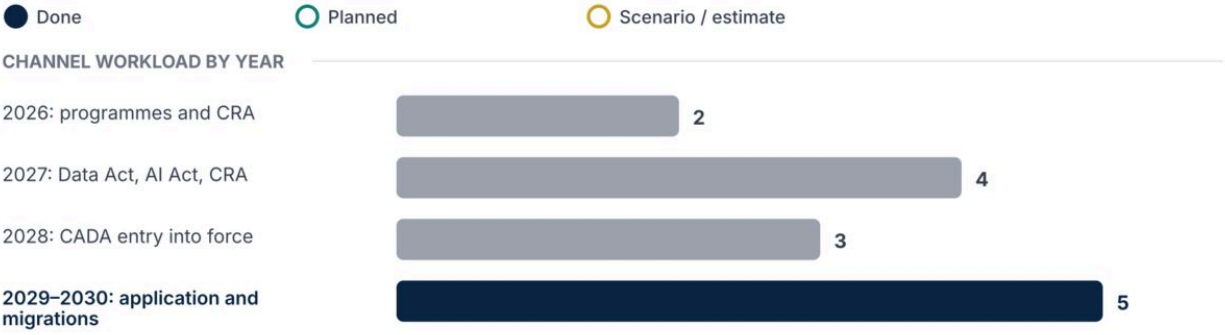
| Check | Indicative evidence | Criterion |
|---|---|---|
| **Are all subcontractors with a direct contract declared?** | Subcontractor register | H |
| **Does cybersecurity reflect the state of the art?** | ENS, ISO/IEC 27001 | E |
| **Is there a person responsible for the file and a material changes procedure?** | Appointment and annual plan | Art. 23 |
| **Is the company an SME for the purposes of automatic recognition of level 1?** | Annual accounts and headcount | Art. 17(3) |

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## Two workload peaks for the channel: 2027 (Data Act, AI Act, CRA) and 2029–2030 (CADA and migrations)

Consolidated timeline of regulation and vendor programmes




**TAKEAWAY** The evidence system built in 2027 for the CRA, Data Act and AI Act is the basis for the 2028–2029 CADA file.

Source: [R1]; [R37]; [R44]; [R34]; [R49]–[R79]; [R51]. Relative workload (1–5): illustrative.

> **A negative answer does not prevent selling: it indicates the work still to be done. What matters is that each link knows its gap before the buyer does.**

## Annex D. Glossary

### CADA terms

- **CADA (Cloud and AI Development Act):** proposal for a Regulation COM(2026) 502 on the development of cloud and AI in the Union.
- **Union assurance level:** each of the four sovereignty tiers (1 to 4) that a cloud service can reach according to the requirements of Annex II.
- **Third-country control:** the ability of an entity or state outside the Union to exert decisive influence over the provider; it is the factor that separates levels 2 and 3.
- **Declaration of conformity:** document with which a provider demonstrates level 1 of a service through self-assessment.
- **Recognition:** decision of the national authority confirming level 2, 3 or 4 of a service following an audit.
- **Central repository:** Commission register of recognised services.
- **Material change:** a change to the service or the provider that may affect its level and must be notified.
- **Public-sector risk assessment:** mandatory analysis identifying public-order activities and the level they require.
- **Public-order activity:** a public activity whose disruption or unlawful access would affect essential functions of the State.
- **Acceleration zone:** an area designated by a Member State to facilitate the deployment of data centres.
- **Strategic project:** a data centre that meets at least two of the five criteria in Article 14.
- **EuroCloud Federation:** voluntary federation of public bodies for sharing cloud capacity.
- **European added value:** non-price award criteria that reward EU technology and hardware.

### Channel terms

- **Broadline distributor:** volume distributor focused on logistics, stock and credit.
- **Value-added distributor (VAD):** specialist distributor with technical pre-sales, multi-vendor integration, training and services.
- **Two-tier distribution:** model in which the vendor sells to the distributor, which sells to the integrator or reseller.
- **Systems integrator:** company that designs, deploys and integrates technology solutions for the end customer.

INFOGRAPHIC 35 · ANNEX C

## A negative answer does not prevent selling: it shows each link's outstanding work

Summary of the checklist by player

| | Vendor | Distributor | Integrator |
|---|---|---|---|
| Telemetry and diagnostics in the EU | High | Low | Medium |
| Local management or EU region | High | Low | Low |
| Support from the EU | High | Medium | Low |
| SBOM and vulnerabilities (CRA) | High | Medium | Low |
| No-AI-training clause | High | Low | Medium |
| Sovereignty sheet published | Medium | High | Low |
| CRA check at onboarding | Low | High | — |
| EU establishment and infrastructure | Low | Low | High |
| Declared subcontractors | Low | Low | High |
| File owner | Low | Medium | High |

**USE** Each player can answer its part in 2027 and share it along the chain: the integrator's file is built from vendor and distributor pieces.

Source: [R1] Annexes II and III; [R45] CRA. Allocation by player: our own analysis.

- **MSP / MSSP:** managed service provider / managed security service provider.
- **Partner programme:** framework of tiers, competencies, incentives and benefits that a vendor offers its channel.
- **Deal registration:** mechanism that protects a partner's opportunity with the vendor.
- **CSP:** Microsoft programme for reselling cloud services through the channel.
- **Multiparty private offer (MPO, CPPO):** sale of software on a hyperscaler marketplace with a margin for the partner.
- **Consumption model:** pay-per-use infrastructure (for example, HPE GreenLake, Dell APEX, Lenovo TruScale).
- **ITAD:** IT asset disposition: retirement, certified erasure and reuse of technology assets.
- **Sovereignty sheet:** proposed by this report; a document per product family containing the sovereignty information provided by the vendor.

### Technical and market terms

- **Hyperscaler:** large global cloud infrastructure provider with massive computing capacity.
- **IaaS, PaaS, SaaS:** infrastructure, platform and software as a service.
- **Telemetry:** technical data that systems send about their operation, often to the vendor's support centres.
- **SBOM:** software bill of materials; an inventory of a product's components and dependencies.
- **HSM:** hardware security module for safeguarding cryptographic keys.
- **PUE:** power usage effectiveness, a data centre energy efficiency indicator; the closer to 1, the better.
- **Open stack:** a set of open-source software covering everything from infrastructure to applications.
- **Edge:** processing in nodes close to where data is generated.
- **Data space:** federated ecosystem in which participants share data under common rules without centralising it.
- **Connector:** component that enables a participant to exchange data in a data space while enforcing usage policies.
- **ODRL:** standard language for expressing machine-readable data usage policies.
- **OSPO:** an organisation's open source programme office.

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- **AI Act:** Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 on artificial intelligence.
- **Data Act:** Regulation (EU) 2023/2854 on data, which includes cloud provider switching.
- **NIS2:** Directive (EU) 2022/2555 on the cybersecurity of essential and important entities.
- **CSA2:** proposal for a new Cybersecurity Regulation (2026), successor to the Cybersecurity Act.
- **EUCS:** European cybersecurity certification scheme for cloud services, currently blocked.
- **CRA:** Regulation (EU) 2024/2847 on cyber resilience.
- **DORA:** Regulation (EU) 2022/2554 on digital operational resilience for the financial sector.
- **DMA:** Digital Markets Act.

- **EHDS:** Regulation (EU) 2025/327 on the European Health Data Space.
- **ENS:** Spain's National Security Framework (Esquema Nacional de Seguridad, Royal Decree 311/2022).
- **SecNumCloud:** French ANSSI framework for trusted cloud services.
- **WEEE:** waste electrical and electronic equipment (Royal Decree 110/2015).
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